When Silver Isn't Gold: Quantifying and Auditing Group-Based Disagreement in Human and LLM Annotation

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LLM-as-judge systems are increasingly used as scalable substitutes for human annotators, including in polarized, subjective tasks where human annotators systematically disagree along group lines. Whether these systems reproduce, ignore, or distort human polarization patterns is largely untested, in part because existing methods for attributing this disagreement may be unreliable in realistic and subjective annotation settings. In this work, we find that their unreliability partially rests on the faulty assumptions that all systematic disagreement can be attributed to at least one annotator group and that each such group has a uniform bias across items . Instead of using these methodologies, we develop a method following a clustering approach that resolves both failure modes, enabling this to be quantifiably attributed to any annotator group. Using this method, we audit LLM-as-judge systems against real human annotation datasets and find that their disagreement patterns are largely disconnected from those of human annotators, a gap that persists even when models are explicitly prompted to condition on persona characteristics. We validate the underlying method on simulated data, showing it remains reliable under group-size imbalance and disagreement with conflicting directions that degrade current approaches. Overall, our results suggest that persona-conditioning alone is insufficient for LLM judges to replicate the structure of human disagreement.

CCS Concepts: • **Computing methodologies** → **Natural language processing**; **Unsupervised learning**; Language resources; • **Human-centered computing** → **Empirical studies in collaborative and social computing**; • **Social and professional topics** → *Race and ethnicity*; *Gender*; Sexual orientation; Age.

Additional Key Words and Phrases: Polarization, Clustering, Annotation, Sociodemographic Characteristics, Persona-Prompting

ACM Reference Format:

Anonymous Author(s). 2026. When Silver Isn't Gold: Quantifying and Auditing Group-Based Disagreement in Human and LLM Annotation. 1, 1 (October 2026), 49 pages. https://doi.org/10.1145/nnnnnnn.nnnnnnn

1 Introduction

The rise of internet spaces has necessitated research in subjective phenomena such as the detection of harmful content. Annotations are needed to support social science research, the training of automated classifiers and the proactive identification of vulnerable groups [53]. Most current annotated datasets typically contain items with very low IAA [53], which if ignored may provide us with the wrong signal, leading to significant misconfiguration in trained AI systems [51]. For example, toxicity models have disproportionately marked African American (AA) speech as "toxic" [45], or systematically ignored minority opinions [41] in the past. Indeed, the disagreement itself may provide us with valuable information [38].

In practice, researchers usually use IAA metrics to distinguish between general and systematic disagreement (Fig. 1). Traditional metrics however hold significant limitations, especially when few annotations per item are available and

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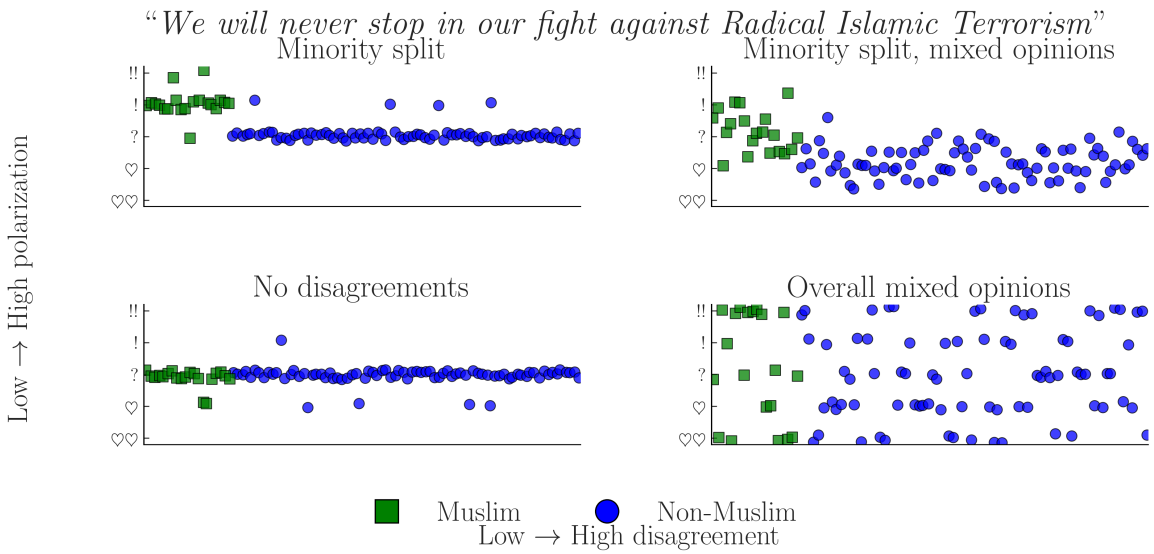


Fig. 1. Simulated experiment exploring four scenarios of a Hate Speech (HS) detection task applied to a controversial statement. The variance in annotations across different annotators may cause traditional Inter-Annotator Agreement (IAA) metrics to ignore minority opinions, especially when opinions are mixed (top-right).

when the studied groups are imbalanced. Both of these issues are typically present in subjective tasks featuring minority groups, which is the exact case where our metrics should be reliable. We therefore ask RQ 1.

RQ 1: *How can we Quantitatively Attribute Systematic Disagreement to Annotator Groups*? We first confirm that prior approaches generally fail in realistic annotation scenarios (Finding 1). Some fail because inter-comment annotation aggregation violates their assumptions (Finding 2), while others fail to account for Unnatributtable Polarization (UnPol), whose existence we discover through the exhaustive creation of theoretical annotator groups (Finding 3). In order to overcome these issues, we introduce a new metric which *quantitatively* attributes systematic disagreement to specific Personal Characteristics (PCs), outperforming prior approaches in realistic annotation scenarios (Fig. 2).

As human annotation is generally expensive, LLM-as-judge systems are increasingly deployed as scalable substitutes for human annotators [24, 43] to acquire a cheaper, "bronze" supervision signal in place of human-annotated "silver" or "gold" labels. It is therefore imperative that systematic disagreements by human annotators be preserved by LLMs whose annotations by default gravitate toward the statistical average [5]. Persona-prompting is sometimes used to bypass this limitation, but suffers from its own challenges such as stereotyping and inconsistent annotations [30, 32]. Unlike prior work which framed the question of LLM annotation reliability in terms of human-LLM agreement [11, 16, 33] or task-specific performance [21], ask the following RQ.

RQ 2: *Which Systematic Disagreement Patterns are Shared Between Human and LLM Annotators*? We analyze human and LLM annotation patterns across five real-life subjective datasets (§5.3). Human disagreements are attributed to gender and ethnicity across most datasets (Finding 4). On the other hand, LLMs using persona-prompting generally fail to reproduce any systematic subgroup disagreement patterns regardless of instruction prompt, confirming literature suggesting that persona prompting does not consistently influence LLM outputs in the examined tasks (Finding 5).

Our work makes the following contributions: (1) The identification and diagnosis of some previously unknown, but severe issues present in prior disagreement attribution methodologies. (2) A new attribution metric that disambiguates systematic from general disagreement and is robust to small annotator counts, realistic subgroup disagreement effects and imbalanced group splits which are common when analyzing minority annotations. (3) An evaluation on LLM disagreement patterns attributable to PCs included in their persona prompts in subjective annotation scenarios. We also release a PyPI library implementing our metric to aid future research in this topic and provide suggestions for subjective dataset creation in §6.

Content Warning: Controversial and potentially harmful speech used for demonstration purposes only.

2 Background and Related Work

Terminology. We distinguish three related definitions used throughout this work. (1) **Disagreement** represents any variance among annotators' ratings for the same item, regardless of its source. (2) **Systematic disagreement** is the subset of disagreement that is non-random and recurring, which in this work is assumed to be caused by differences in group identity (e.g., background, cultural context, sociodemographic characteristics). (3) **Polarization** is the underlying societal phenomenon describing genuinely conflicting, opposed viewpoints on the same item.

Agreement. Current work on analyzing subjective tasks rests on using IAA between groups of annotators [23, 25, 29, 35, 50, 52], as research has shown that consistent, systematic disagreement may be caused by different points-of-view between groups [17, 35, 51]. IAA metrics such as Cohen's kappa, Krippendorff's alpha, and Fleiss's kappa aim to distinguish genuine disagreement from random disagreement through statistical chance-correction. However, these metrics are often difficult to apply to intergroup IAA without extensions or restrictive assumptions (e.g., no missing labels or equal numbers of annotations). They have also been criticized for failing to account for differences arising from social, cultural, and demographic backgrounds [6, 7, 14, 52], producing results that are difficult to compare across studies, being sensitive to class imbalance [14], and relying on questionable assumptions about chance agreement [7]. While recent work has addressed some of these limitations with methods that improve applicability and robustness [23, 52, 57], they are much more complex and less intuitive, indicating that IAA may not be the correct tool for analysis of minority viewpoints. Ultimately, IAA analysis may be useful for exploration and identification of some controversial items, but fails to explain the reason *why* they are controversial [1, 54].

LLM Annotation. Prior work suggests that LLMs are not necessarily reliable annotators when prompted with personas, as they tend to reproduce stereotypes [30, 32] and perform unreliably for minority groups [32]. To address subjectivity in annotation, several Natural Language Processing (NLP) approaches incorporate annotator metadata into LLM fine-tuning [10, 15, 20, 44], although evidence suggests that such improvements may be specific to the datasets on which models are trained [28]. An alternative line of work recovers annotator perspectives through clustering in embedding space [55], although these representations can be difficult to interpret, computationally expensive to obtain and evaluate, and sensitive to the quality of the underlying embeddings. We instead posit that directly clustering the annotations provides a comparatively simpler and more interpretable mechanism.

Polarization. There are multiple competing formulations for estimating polarization besides IAA. One of these approaches [2] utilizes χ^2 to estimate in-group vs out-group variance. Others frame systematic disagreement as a cluster identification problem, applying either parametric (GMM) [7], or non-parametric [34, 38] approaches to the annotation histograms. For our work, we use a non-parametric disagreement metric, normalized Distance From

Unimodality (nDFU), which has been shown to correlate better with human judgment of disagreement than established metrics [38], although we compare prior approaches in Fig. 2. nDFU (Eq. 1) takes values in the range $[0, 1]$, where values close to 0 indicate no polarization (i.e., opinions are concentrated around a single mode). Intuitively, nDFU measures how prominent secondary peaks are compared to the main peak (see Fig. 4, left for an example). The A Posteriori Unimodality (AU) method [38] builds upon nDFU stating that if a single item's annotations are multimodal, but unimodal for all annotator subgroups, then polarization is explained by those groups. Though promising, this mechanism operates on the assumption that *all* polarization can be explained by a single split, which we prove to be impossible in many cases (§4).

$$\text{nDFU}(X) = \frac{\max_{i \neq m} \left(f_i - \begin{cases} f_{i-1}, & \text{if } i > m \\ f_{i+1}, & \text{if } i < m \end{cases} \right)}{f_m}, m = \arg\max_i f_i \tag{1}$$

where, X denotes the set of annotations, f_i the relative frequency of the i-th annotation (e.g., the frequency of 2 in a scale of 1–5), and m the histogram peak.

3 Datasets

Table 1. Datasets used in this study. *#Ann / Item* refers to the number of annotators per item, while the *Guidelines* column describers whether annotation guidelines are provided in the publication introducing the dataset. **#PCs** refers to the number of PC dimensions (e.g., age, gender, education).

Dataset	#Items	#Ann / Item	#PCs	Text Source	Task	Guidelines
Kumar [26]	1000	5	10	Twitter, Reddit, 4chan	Toxicity	Yes
Sap [46]	585	5–6	3	Twitter	Hate Speech	No
DICES-350 [3]	350	123	4	LLM responses	Hate Speech	No
DICES-990 [3]	990	70–76	4	LLM responses	Hate Speech	No
POPQUORN [39]	1500	7–9	5	Reddit	Hate Speech	Yes

Finding appropriate subjective datasets to test LLMs on is difficult for many reasons: (1) Very few include annotator metadata [55]. (2) Most include only three annotators per item (e.g., [9, 27, 36, 48, 49]). (3) Many datasets are sampled from the same source, negatively impacting the breadth of possible generalizable findings [53]. (4) Annotation guidelines are frequently not included [53], complicating replication. Additionally, we were unable to find recent surveys on subjective datasets. The ones we found [40, 53] do not give special importance to the sparsity of annotations per item, which is an important consideration for such datasets. We highlight the extent of this problem and discuss possible solutions in §6. Nevertheless, given the current state of research, we aim to provide a methodology that can adapt to this challenging environment, similarly to the motivation given in prior work [55]. We use five datasets from current NLP research that contain PC information at the level of individual annotators and provide a satisfactory annotation density per item:

- The *Kumar* dataset [26] which contains annotations for Toxicity detection.
- The *Sap* "Breadth of Posts" dataset with the "*toyou*" labels [46] for HS detection.
- The *DICES-350* (*Q3_bias_targeting_inherited_attributes* label) and *DICES-990* (*Q3_bias_incites_hatred* label) datasets [3], which pertain to LLM response safety. Our choice of labels allows us to use them as HS datasets,

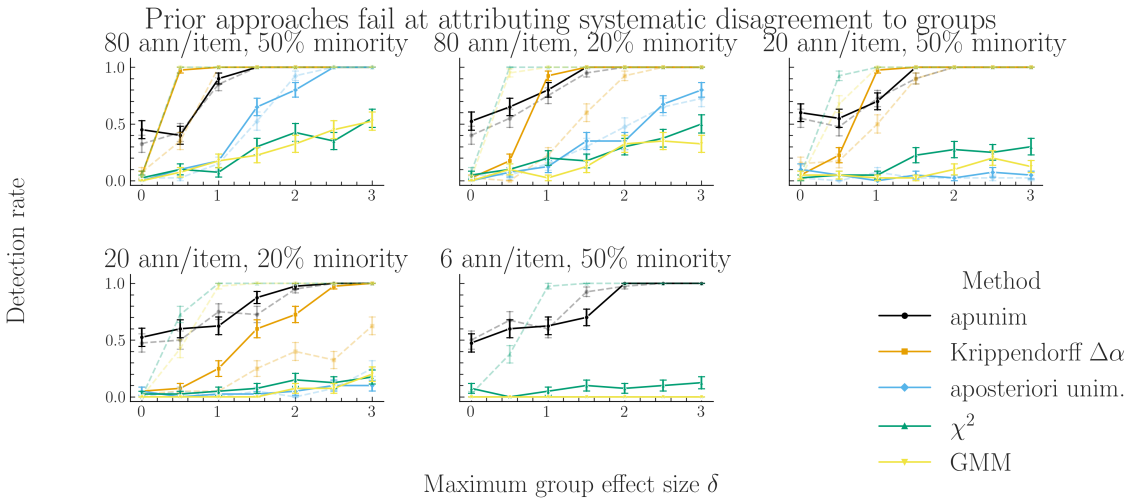


Fig. 2. Polarization group attribution on synthetic distributions. Bars indicate standard error. We assign a number of annotators per item, and split the annotator groups 50-50 or 80-20. Higher δ represents higher polarization. Apunim is adept at attributing systematic disagreements to the correct group regardless of number of annotators per item, or how these annotators are split. Dashed lines show the results of a simplified experimental setup, where disagreement always has the same direction.

capturing conceptually similar dimensions despite the lack of shared label names between them. There is little-to-not information around these labels, since neither a description nor the annotation guidelines are provided.

- The POPQUORN [39] dataset using the *"offensiveness"* label for HS detection.[1]

A brief overview of the dataset characteristics is provided in Table 1. The Kumar dataset is notable for its large scale, featuring over 100,000 annotated items and 10 distinct PC dimensions. In contrast, the DICES datasets have fewer annotated items but involve more than an order of magnitude more annotators per item than the others. The POPQUORN dataset presents both a modest number of annotators per item (7-9) and items. The full datasets are used for the human annotation analysis in §5 and their PC labels and texts as input for the LLM annotation in §5.3. In order to allow for a full comparison between human and LLM annotations, we use a sample of 1,000 items from the Kumar dataset. Our results remain consistent for both different samples and differently-sized samples (App. E.2). Further details on the annotations, including overall levels of observed polarization (nDFU), are available in App. B,

4 Why Do Current Methods Fail?

4.1 On Synthetic Data

Setup. We compare the effectiveness of our method (introduced in §5), the AU framework proposed by Pavlopoulos and Likas [38], the χ^2 method presented in Akhtar et al. [2], GMM clustering used in Checco et al. [7], and a baseline using IAA ($\Delta\alpha$ Krippendorff) on simulated distributions. To determine whether a score is statistically significant, we construct a null distribution for each method with the null hypothesis that the group labels are unrelated to the observed

[1]While the dataset also contains "politeness" labels, these may not directly translate to toxicity detection; comments can simultaneously be toxic and phrased politely. Indeed, toxicity is not mentioned in the methodology of the original POPQUORN dataset and is considered a separate NLP task in other work [31, 59].

annotations. We therefore repeatedly shuffle the group labels across annotators, recompute the method's statistic, and use the resulting scores to form the null distribution. The observed score is then compared with this distribution.

Conditions. Annotations are generated according to $y_{ij} = b_j + g_i p_j + \epsilon_{ij}$, where b_j is the baseline rating for item j, $g_i \in \{-\frac{1}{2}, +\frac{1}{2}\}$ indicates the annotator's group, p_j controls the magnitude and direction of systematic disagreement for item j, and ϵ_{ij} is annotation noise. We try two simulation setups that differ only in how p_j is defined: (1) **Unidirectional**: $p_j \sim \text{Uniform}(0, \delta)$. The group effect always favours the same group across all items, though its magnitude varies per item. (2) **Bidirectional**: $p_j \sim \text{Uniform}(-\delta, +\delta)$. The direction of the group effect can vary across items, so that groups may systematically disagree in opposite directions on different items (see Finding 2).

Results. As shown in Fig. 2, *both the χ^2 and GMM methods generally fail* at attributing systematic disagreements to the correct group. IAA remains competitive when many annotators are available, but underperforms in cases where the examined group is a minority and when a few annotators are available per item (a common case among NLP datasets—see §3).[2]

4.2 On Real Data

Table 2 shows a comparison between the different methods when applied to the five datasets introduced in §3. The GMM method is not run, as it requires the exact same annotators to annotate the items in each dataset, which is not the case for any of our datasets. This limitation makes the test extremely restrictive in realistic annotation settings. We explain our own method in §5, as the focus of this experiment is the behavior of other metrics on real data.

We find that the AU method completely fails to attribute polarization to any group, while the χ^2 method attributes it to all groups. The latter can be explained by the assumptions made by the test; namely that annotations can be pooled across items (discussed in the next section), as well as the power of the test which inflates p-values when $N_{observations}$ is large enough.[3] Out of all prior methodologies, IAA using Krippendorff's α seems to be the only way of obtaining any results for only a subset of datasets.

Finding 1. *Current methodologies attributing systematic disagreement generally fail in realistic annotation conditions.*

4.3 Conflicting Disagreement Directions

In Fig. 2 we observed that the simple statistical approaches do indeed show excellent performance when all groups are polarized in the same direction. This is expected, since they rely on consistent fixed means effects, which is disrupted by opposing disagreement effects violating their assumptions on fixed mean differences between groups. Specifically, both χ^2 and GMM aggregate across items before looking for group differences; χ^2 pools all annotations into a single contingency table, while GMM clusters annotators by their mean rating across items. In both cases, opposite-direction effects cancel out in the aggregate, making the two groups appear statistically indistinguishable. Thus, while these methods perform well in ideal conditions, they may completely fail on realistic annotation datasets.

We can confirm the persistence of this issue using nDFU [38], which is another representation of polarization (see §2). Fig. 3 shows that two items polarized for the opposite reason may lead to a false negative. We avoid this issue in §5 by operating item-by-item, asking whether the annotation distribution becomes unimodal when conditioned on group membership, without assuming a consistent direction of disagreement across items.

[2]Ablations with $k = \{3, 5, 10\}$ groups can be found in App. E.2; Fig. 9.
[3]Some of these issues could be fixed by modifying the original test used in Akhtar et al. [2], but is outside the scope of this work.

Table 2. Statistical significance of each PC feature per method. ✓: significant at $p < 0.05$ after Bonferroni correction across the features of the dataset; ×: not significant.

	PC	apunim	Krippendorff $\Delta\alpha$	aposteriori unim.	χ^2
DICES-350	Age	×	×	×	✓
	Education	✓	×	×	✓
	Gender	×	✓	×	✓
	Race	✓	✓	×	✓
DICES-990	Age	✓	×	×	✓
	Education	✓	✓	×	✓
	Gender	✓	✓	×	✓
	Race	✓	×	×	✓
Sap et al. 2022	Age	×	×	×	✓
	Ethnicity	×	×	×	✓
	Gender	✓	✓	×	✓
Kumar et al. 2021	Age	×	×	×	✓
	Education	×	×	×	✓
	Ethnicity	×	×	×	✓
	Gender	×	×	×	✓
	Has Been Targeted	×	×	×	✓
	Is Parent	×	×	×	✓
	Is Transgender	×	×	×	✓
	Political Affiliation	×	×	×	✓
	Religion Important	×	×	×	✓
	Seen Toxicity	×	×	×	✓
	Sexual Orientation	×	×	×	✓
	Technology Impact	×	×	×	✓
	Toxicity Problem	×	×	×	✓
POPQUORN	Age	×	×	×	✓
	Education	✓	×	×	✓
	Gender	×	×	×	✓
	Occupation	×	×	×	✓
	Race	✓	×	×	✓

Finding 2. *Systematic disagreements may conflict across items, which may compromise cross-item annotation aggregation.*

4.4 Inherent Polarization

Opposing disagreement may explain the failure of statistical methods, but not the proposed AU method which operates only on a single item's annotation histogram. The under-performance of AU could instead be attributed to a violation of its assumptions. Indeed, a newly discovered phenomenon we call UnPol comes in direct contrast to the assumption that all systematic disagreement can be explained by a split in annotations.[4]

What Is It? UnPol refers to disagreement that cannot be attributed to *any arbitrary* group. AU attributes polarization to groups only when all each individual groups show completely unimodal annotation histograms. For example, in Fig. 4

[4]Given the terminology in §2 UnPol is an inaccurate term as it does not petrain to

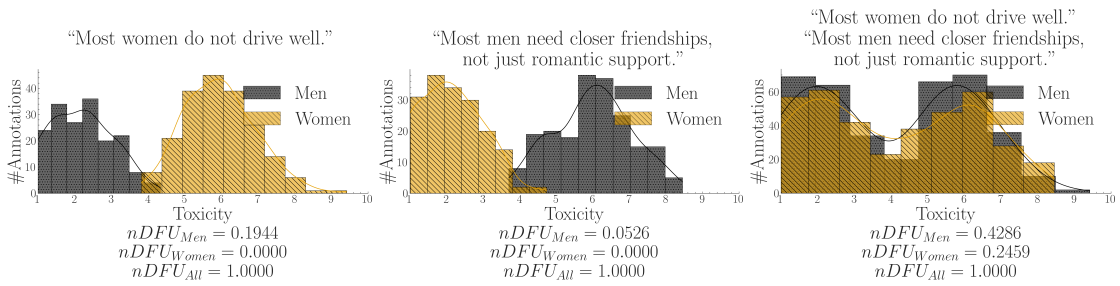


Fig. 3. Synthetic experiment showing two comments with annotators disagreeing about which one is toxic. Instead of comparing two unimodal distributions (comments viewed separately) with two bimodal distributions (their aggregated annotations), we end up comparing two bimodal distributions during aggregation, obscuring the source of the polarization (explained by gender, but not shown).

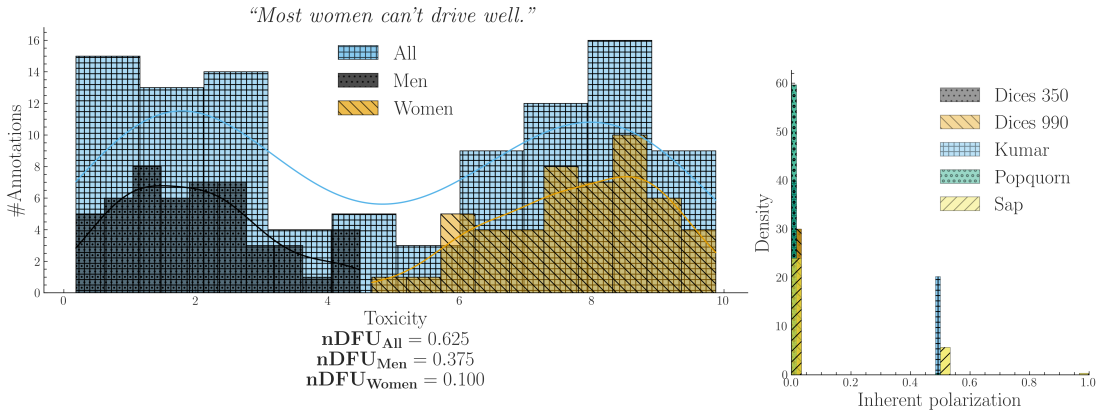


Fig. 4. **Left:** Simulated experiment describing a polarizing comment where men and women agree between themselves, but disagree with the opposite gender. **Right:** UnPol across our datasets (§3). Contrary to assumptions made in prior work, UnPol is commonly non-zero and can even reach $nDFU = 1$ in datasets with low annotator counts.

left, AU would only attribute polarization if $nDFU(all) > nDFU(men) = nDFU(women) = 0$). The presence of UnPol would invalidate this assumption, since there would be no possible group or combination of groups g *s.t.* $nDFU(g) = 0$.[5]

Formally, the UnPol for a single item c is the minimum nDFU exhibited by any arbitrary group (Eq. 2). When considered exhaustively, these theoretical, random splits produce both observed and latent groups. Since nDFU operates only when a group has at least three annotators (Eq. 1), this yields $\sum_{k=3}^{n} \binom{n}{k}$ possible groups, which is computationally intractable for large annotator counts. We can therefore use Monte Carlo sampling by drawing k random partitions with random sizes (Eq. 3) which serves as an upper bound (as it considers a strict subset of Eq. 2).

$$\mathrm{Pol}_{inh}(c) = \min_{S \in G_c} \{\mathrm{nDFU}(S)\} \tag{2}$$

$$\mathrm{Pol}^{MC}_{inh}(c) = \min_{j=1}^{k} \{\mathrm{nDFU}(S_j)\} \tag{3}$$

where G_c is the collection of all subsets S of annotations for an item c such that $|S| \geq 3$ and S_j is a random sample drawn from G_c for $j = 1, \ldots, k$.

[5]Fig. 4 also shows a clear failure mode of AU regardless of assumptions. While it is obvious that in the example polarization is caused by gender, AU expects *total* unimodality to attribute it.

Does It Exist? We compute the UnPol for each item across the four datasets. For Sap and Kumar, we use the exhaustive formulation (Eq. 2), whereas for the two DICES datasets we rely on the Monte Carlo approximation with $k = 1000$ (Eq. 3). Fig. 4 (right) shows that in all DICES items there exists at least one group that fully accounts for the observed nDFU even when repeatedly subsampling down to 6 annotators.[6][7] Interestingly, this observation does not hold for the Kumar and Sap datasets, despite evaluating all possible annotator groups exhaustively. Therefore, even if UnPol was not responsible for the degraded performance of AU in our synthetic data, it would certainly have an impact when applied in real-world datasets. See App. B; Table 10 for examples of items with high UnPol.

Finding 3. *Items may exhibit a degree of UnPol that cannot be attributed to any known or latent annotator grouping.*

5 Comparing Human and LLM Polarization

5.1 Quantifying Attribution to Annotator Groups

Instead of using UnPol, which represents the minimum possible systematic disagreement exhibited by any group, we calculate the *expected* (average). Therefore, we do not test whether the group is polarized against the whole; nor whether the group explains *some polarization* (as would be the case if we used Eq. 2), but rather whether the group explains polarization *more than other groups*.

Specifically, we define apriori polarization for an item c as $\text{Pol}_{apr}(c) = \mathbb{E}_{S\sim G_c}[\text{nDFU}(S)]$, which is averaged across items for a dataset D. Intuitively, a high $\text{Pol}_{apr}(c)$ score means that much of the polarization is likely not driven by any single group. We compare this quantity with the average observed nDFU of all items, which yields our normalized metric, *apunim* (Eq. 4). We explain why defining $\text{Pol}_{apr}(c)$ in this way is preferable to alternatives in App. C.3. The *sign* of apunim carries information agreement-based attribution does not:

- $apunim(g) \approx 0$: The group g does not meaningfully disagree with the other annotators.
- $apunim(g) > 0$: The group g has fundamental disagreements with the other annotators.
- $apunim(g) < 0$: The annotators of group g are polarized between themselves.

$$apunim(D, g) = \frac{\mathbb{E}_{c\in D}\left[\text{Pol}_{apr}(c)\right] - \mathbb{E}_{c\in D}\left[Pol_g(c)\right]}{1 - \mathbb{E}_{c\in D}\left[\text{Pol}_{apr}(c)\right]} \tag{4}$$

where Pol_g is the observed nDFU in the annotations of an item c created by annotators belonging to group g.

Apunim thus measures the degree to which an annotator group contributes to overall polarization in a set of items. As demonstrated in §4; Fig. 2, our metric is robust to the number of annotators per item, opposing systematic disagreement effects, and minority groups, validating our initial motivation. Furthermore, unlike some prior methods [2, 7], apunim allows us to attribute systematic disagreement to a specific group, not a PC dimension, allowing fine-grained analysis. We include a perturbation-based p-value estimation, which tests whether the observed apunim value of a group g statistically surpasses that of random groups in App. C.1.

5.2 How Are Humans Polarized?

Experimental Setup. Assuming a confidence level of $\alpha = 0.05$ we test whether any of the provided PC dimensions can explain the systematic disagreements shown in the four datasets (§3). Statistically significant results are presented in

[6] $Pol^{MC}_{inh}(c) = 0 \Rightarrow Pol_{inh}(c) = 0$ due to Eq. 3, as is the case of increased k in Eq. 3.
[7] See App. E.2 for why this observation could be explained by DICES being structurally different.

Table 3. Statistically significant ($p < 0.05$) apunim results across the Sap and DICES datasets. Gray rows show `Ethnicity` and `Gender` groups. "Support" refers to number of annotations. Consult App. G for the full results.

Group	Apunim	Support
DICES-990		
Ethnicity=AfricanAm	0.099	5148
Ethnicity=Latino	-0.063	5877
Ethnicity=Other	0.034	21669
Ethnicity=White	-0.065	10166
Gender=Man	0.036	28817
Gender=Woman	-0.027	29990
Age=GenZ	0.047	12214
Age=Millennial	-0.007	34433
Age=GenX+	-0.028	12699
Education=College	0.006	52727
Education=High school	-0.050	6619
DICES-350		
Ethnicity=AfricanAm	-0.037	7627
Ethnicity=Asian	0.045	6838
Education=Other	-0.023	1841
Sap		
Gender=Man	0.0907	1439
Gender=Woman	-0.2442	877
POPQUORN		
Gender=Man	0.0081	2720
Race=Black	-0.1572	222
Education=College	0.0496	2388
Education=Graduate	-0.0808	468

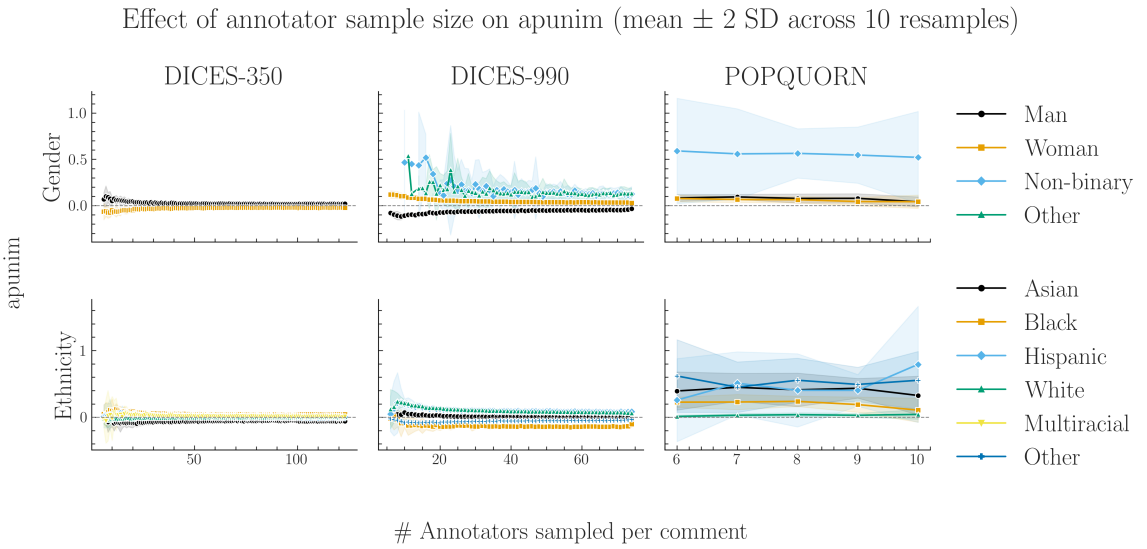


Fig. 5. Standard Deviation (SD) of *apunim* across items, averaged across 10 runs, where each item is resampled 100 times. Shaded areas represent two SDs. Non-statistically significant results from Table 3 remain systematically close to zero, while statistically significant results can be distinguished from very small annotator counts (six annotators for well-balanced groups, ≈ 20 for poorly split groups such as non-binary annotators in DICES-990).

Table 3.[8] Note that the lack of rich annotation data prevents us from analyzing how different annotator groups interact and thus our analysis is necessarily uni-dimensional. See App. C.2 for details on other parameters and execution times, and App. G for the full results.

[8]The results are not necessarily contingent on a reliable p-value estimation, as non-statistically significant results have very low (< 0.01) apunim values. A threshold on the apunim values would produce similar tables.

Table 4. Mean (SE) per-comment nDFU of the human annotations and of the LLM annotations under the default prompt, per dataset and pooled over all datasets (All). *n* is the number of comments.

	Sap et al. 2022		Kumar et al. 2021		All	
Model	n	Mean (SE)	n	Mean (SE)	n	Mean (SE)
Human	585	0.38 (0.01)	1000	0.42 (0.01)	1585	0.41 (0.01)
olmo32b	585	0.24 (0.01)	1000	0.51 (0.01)	1585	0.41 (0.01)
qwen32b	585	0.18 (0.01)	1000	0.19 (0.01)	1585	0.19 (0.01)
qwen7b	585	0.30 (0.01)	1000	0.51 (0.01)	1585	0.43 (0.01)

Results. Systematic disagreements are consistently attributed to ***ethnicity*** across all datasets excluding DICES-330, confirming prior work suggesting that it is a systematic source of annotator disagreement in HS tasks [17].[9] Additionally, in both DICES-990, Sap and POPQUORN, ***men*** *are a consistent source of systematic disagreement* (positive values), while in the two former datasets **women** disagree among themselves (positive values), which is consistent with previous findings [4, 56]. None of the Kumar dimensions show statistically significant values, but this is expected, as our methodology requires at least six annotators per item to work reliably.

Robustness. **To Annotator Size:** We run an ablation experiment for datasets with more than six annotators per item (excluding Kumar and Sap), where we systematically subsample them with replacement. Fig. 5 shows that our results are *robust to small annotator counts*, corroborating the synthetic experiments in Fig. 2. **To Annotator Group Splits:** Sampling annotators with replacement also uncovers a new group which systematically disagrees with the others; the Non-Binary annotators in the POPQUORN and DICES-990 datasets. This group was undetectable when partitioning annotator groups with the methodology described in Eq. 4 since only one item is annotated by three *Non-Binary* annotators in POPQUORN and none for DICES-990, but sampling with replacement uncovers a very strong attribution. Using this technique may solve this limitation of our methodology. **As Compared to Prior Methods:** Our results are similar to those produced by IAA, as was shown in Table 2, although unlike apunim, the latter could not attribute *any* disagreement to the POPQUORN dataset.

Finding 4. *Annotator ethnicity and gender are consistent causes of systematic disagreements, confirming prior literature on Toxicity and HS tasks.*

5.3 How Are LLMs Polarized?

Experimental Procedure. We investigate six open-source LLMs (two discarded because of prompt sensitivity—see App. F; Table 14) using twenty annotators for the Kumar, Sap and POPQUORN datasets supplied with personas sampled from our human dataset. While LLM annotation can be scaled to be arbitrarily large, the choice of twenty annotators is a compromise between practical computation costs and enough annotation density to facilitate exploration. We do not annotate the DICES datasets since the annotations are wildly inconsistent (App. F; Table 14), which we can not readily fix as their original annotation guidelines are not public (§3; Table 1). See App. F for the ablation experimental procedure, full results, model details, dataset selection, exploratory analysis, and comparison to human annotations.

[9]Note that AAs show differently signed apunim values in the two DICES datasets, which may be attributed to these datasets using different labels (see §3) and because different ethnic group splits are considered in each dataset. Thus, while detection is constant across the two datasets, attribution is not.

Table 5. Cohen's d between the default and each adversarial instruction prompt, for the nDFU of each group, shown as mean (SD) across groups. Rows give results per model, pooled over all datasets (All) and for each dataset separately; *n* is the number of groups.

Model	Dataset	n	Stereotype	Persona	Single	Direct
olmo32b	All	75	0.13 (0.02)	-0.10 (0.07)	-0.22 (0.18)	-0.26 (0.13)
	Sap et al. 2022	11	0.09 (0.00)	0.06 (0.00)	0.22 (0.00)	0.04 (0.00)
	Kumar et al. 2021	64	0.14 (0.01)	-0.13 (0.01)	-0.29 (0.01)	-0.31 (0.01)
qwen32b	All	75	0.19 (0.05)	0.20 (0.03)	0.42 (0.22)	0.28 (0.08)
	Sap et al. 2022	11	0.32 (0.00)	0.13 (0.00)	-0.09 (0.00)	0.09 (0.00)
	Kumar et al. 2021	64	0.17 (0.01)	0.21 (0.01)	0.51 (0.01)	0.31 (0.01)
qwen7b	All	75	-0.97 (0.41)	-0.76 (0.34)	-0.28 (0.08)	-0.28 (0.10)
	Sap et al. 2022	11	0.02 (0.00)	0.06 (0.00)	-0.09 (0.00)	-0.05 (0.00)
	Kumar et al. 2021	64	-1.14 (0.01)	-0.90 (0.01)	-0.31 (0.01)	-0.32 (0.01)

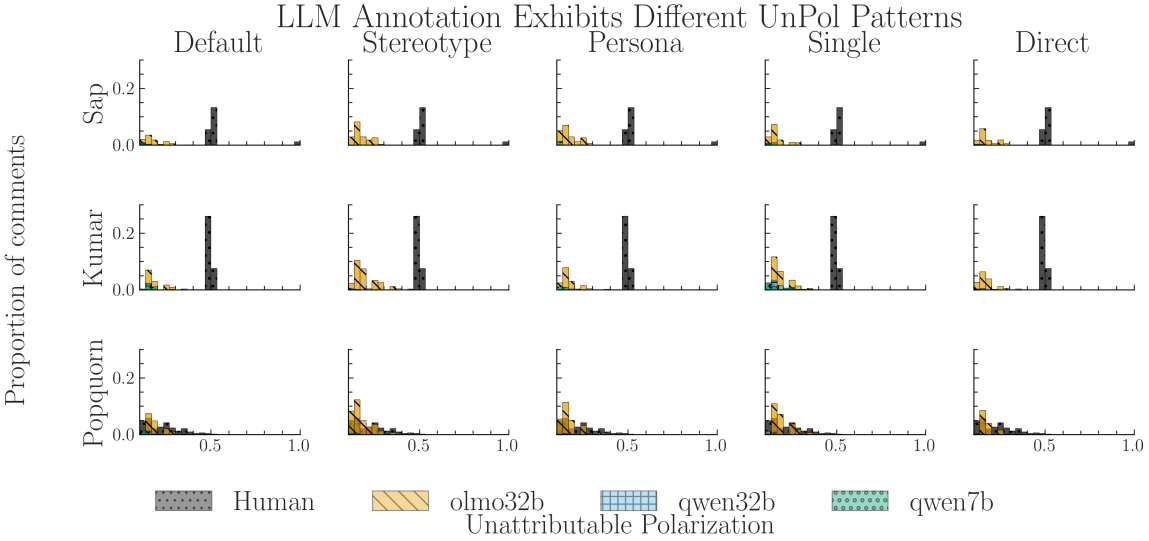


Fig. 6. Normalized histograms showing the UnPol exhibited by each model when truncating annotation to six annotations, compared to human annotations for each dataset. Some LLMs fail to show any UnPol, while the rest show far less than humans. Note that the graph does not include zero UnPol, and the y-axis is truncated to $[0, 0.3]$.

Do LLMs Exhibit Meaningful Disagreement? **Yes**. Table 4 shows that the nDFU values exhibited by LLMs when under standard persona prompting can even surpass those of humans.

Do Instructions Influence the Extent of Disagreement? **No**. We use four adversarial prompts progressively emphasizing the importance of the LLMs' personas (App. H). While an ANOVA test[10] shows that the choice of instruction prompt does indeed affect nDFU scores across most models, the effect is generally small ($|d| \leq 0.3$) and inconsistent. The sign of the effect depends on the model: the stereotype prompt *increases* nDFU for OLMO32B and QWEN32B but sharply *decreases* it for QWEN7B. The effect also varies with the dataset; large shifts for QWEN7B come entirely from Kumar, while on Sap, the same prompts have no effect. Generally, instructions can shift how much LLMs disagree, but no prompt reliably

[10]We use a parametric test due to the abundance of observations ($N = 585, 1000$). We also use a multiple hypothesis p-value correction (specifically the "Holms-Bonferroni" method [22]).

increases nDFU, so prompting alone is not a dependable way to elicit systematic disagreement. See App. G; Table 4 for the actual mean nDFU values by prompt.

Is Any Such Disagreement Unattributable? **Mostly no**. We observe no UnPol from two of the models even when subsampling down to the minimum six annotators (Fig. 6). The only model showing any UnPol is OLMO32B which shows a fraction of human UnPol and variance. This result suggests that even when using prompt engineering and persona prompting, LLMs retain their tendency to default to a statistical average, even if that average differs from the "average human" whose opinions were learned during model pretraining.

Can Systematic Disagreement be Attributed to LLM Persona Characteristics? **No**. Unlike human annotations (Table 3), no model shows any statistically significant apunim results in any group and dataset. Even though we use more annotators per item and assign groups uniformly (benefiting minority opinions), the apunim values for most models are zero because of a lack of polarized items. When polarized items exist, the apunim values are generally small and depend largely on the model and dataset. The values may be circumstiantially large, but this effect seems to be prevalent only on PCs with many groups and may be an artifact of annotation sparsity of that group increasing variance, which would explain why these groups are not statistically significant

FINDING 5. *LLMs with persona-prompting do not produce annotations with detectable UnPol, nor apunim values across any group, while only a few exhibit any multimodal annotations at all. This effect can not be reliably remedied with prompt engineering.*

6 Discussion

Subjective Annotation Properties. As discussed in §3, there is a severe lack of datasets containing annotator metadata for subjective tasks. Given that the creation of these datasets is difficult, expensive and time-consuming, it is important to acknowledge and prioritize certain properties that are necessary for analyzing subjectivity across annotator groups. Since there is to our knowledge no taxonomy on the shape of annotated datasets, we distinguish three main properties:

- Data Coverage (DC), which refers to the number of *items* in a dataset. Due to the focus on training and benchmarking datasets in NLP, this property is usually the one with the most focus and importance [43].
- Group Coverage (GC), which refers to the overall number of *annotators* and their distribution across PC dimensions. A large annotator pool is required to get sufficient coverage on the examined groups and allows both higher fidelity of each PC dimension and more such dimensions to be examined.
- Annotation Density (AD), which refers to the number of *annotators per item*. This property is often neglected in practice, with many datasets [9, 27, 36, 48, 49] assuming "gold labels" can be inferred by three annotators.

The Ideal Subjective Dataset. Subjective datasets should be tailored to their specific use [53], so using very large datasets for social science analysis may not be necessary [43]. While DC may be convenient for training classifiers, relying on it without rigorous evaluation of systematic disagreements can lead to misconfigured or biased models [45], evaluation which is impossible without the necessary DC). However, it comes at the expense of the other two (arguably more important) qualities. Generally, the *easiest-to-use resources for training LLMs and classifiers may be the riskiest*, as meaningful, systematic disagreements cannot be reliably quantified (see the Kumar dataset in this study). We therefore recommend prioritizing dataset creation by first ensuring sufficient AD, then achieving necessary GC across underrepresented groups (see Non-Binary annotator disagreement detection being precluded by group splits in §5), and finally allowing budgetary constraints to determine DC.

What Do Our Results Suggest about LLMs? Overall, our findings support social science work which warns against generating human annotation data without substantial replication studies [24, 43].

Conclusion

We discovered issues regarding the presence of unattributable polarization and conflicting disagreement which render current representations of subgroup disagreement attribution suboptimal in realistic circumstances. We created a new metric that overcomes these issues and outperforms alternative methodologies in realistic annotation settings, while also *quantifying* the attribution of systematic disagreement for each group. By applying this metric to five subjective NLP datasets, we verify that ethnicity and gender seem to generally drive systematic disagreements in Toxicity and HS tasks and find that persona prompting is not generally capable of unlocking consistent subgroup disagreement in subjective annotation tasks, even when using adversarial instruction prompts. Overall, our work indicates that LLMs are not yet capable of capturing the points-of-view of humans on the group-level using persona prompting.

AI Use Statement

In this work we used proprietary models such as Anthropic's Claude Sonnet 5 and OpenAI's GPT-5 for partially implementing the synthetic experiments in §4 and generating parts of the library, experiment and graph-creation code. The unit-tests used in our library were similarly generated by these models, although new tests were added as edge-cases and bugs were discovered. All such tasks were executed with direct author supervision, and all relevant code files (library, experiments, graphs) have been edited manually at multiple points by the authors to ensure reproducibility, accuracy and software quality. We also used Scholar Labs to find citations for targeted claims (e.g., for known issues with persona prompting), although all such citations were manually filtered by us. Finally, we used a locally hosted Gemma-4 model (specifically the `gemma-4-E4B-it-Q4_K_M.gguf` variant) for rephrasing this manuscript in order to improve readability. We take responsibility for the final content of this work, including text, claims or artifacts produced with the aid of generative AI.

Reproducibility Statement

We ensure that our LLM annotation study is reproducible by selecting exclusively open-source, locally hosted models and fixing all relevant seeds. An ablation study where we repeat annotations multiple times shows that our setup achieves 100% consistency across all models. In order to ensure that the LLM annotators are not influenced by minute differences in the prompts, we execute a second ablation study where we rephrase the main annotation prompt three times and compare outputs. This procedure revealed that two models were especially sensitive to such changes, which led us to exclude those models from the analysis presented in this manuscript. Information on the synthetic experiments used in §4,5 is disclosed in App. E.1. We analyze software design decisions, limitations and computational details in App. C.2 and elaborate on our experimental setup in App. C.3, while ablations around sample sizes and sample selection for the Kumar dataset are detailed in App. E.2. Additionally, we include a discussion around the use of current NLP datasets, as well as an empirical estimation of the number of required annotators for reproducible results in App. **??**. All code, environment details (e.g., libraries used), data-processing scripts and our library implementing *apunim* are released anonymously: library https://anonymous.4open.science/r/apunim-5F70, HTML documentation https://anonymous.4open.science/r/apunim-page, replication code https://anonymous.4open.science/r/aposteriori-unimodality-E8C1.

Ethics Statement

Dual Use Concerns. The primary objective of this study is to identify systemic sources of systematic disagreements in subjective NLP datasets to facilitate the construction of more fair and reliable AI systems. However, given that our methodology allows for the quantitative attribution of specific annotation patterns to PCs, we acknowledge three primary risks inherent in this research. (1) *Discriminatory Profiling*: If the metric is applied outside of a dataset quality analysis, its ability to correlate specific opinion patterns with annotator groups could be misused for surveillance or unjust profiling. (2) *Automated Bias Amplification*: The diagnostic patterns of disagreement we detect are reflections of human systemic biases. Without human oversight, training subsequent models on these patterns risks automating and entrenching existing societal prejudices. (3) The knowledge provided by *apunim* could be *weaponized*, allowing malicious actors to strategically target weak points in moderation systems or intentionally maximize societal conflict. We stress that our metric functions strictly as a diagnostic warning signal. Any deployment in a real-world system must mandate a human-in-the-loop review, ensuring that identified patterns lead to systemic improvements (e.g., policy reform, demographic diversity initiatives) rather than merely justifying an automated system. In any case, despite the risks, we believe that the benefits of this research outweigh the risks outlined above.

Data Sourcing and Privacy. All datasets employed in this study were either publicly accessible or provided to us by the original authors with full disclosure regarding the purpose of our research. No identifiable, personal information was included in our pipeline. We do not release proprietary data provided by the authors, nor have we provided any to proprietary LLMs. Finally, we note that our data is limited to English posts from a U.S. cultural context and our results may not be representative for other cultures.

Examples Used. Our study utilizes examples of comments that may be considered divisive across certain demographics. These examples were generated by our team solely for demonstration purposes. We explicitly state that the contents of these examples and the groups studied do not necessarily reflect the views or behaviors of the groups they represent, nor do they reflect the opinions of the authors. We have partially censored explicit slurs in Table 10 in order to both mitigate uncomfortable or triggering content, while also showing enough content for the examples to be effective.

Prompts Used. This study uses adversarial prompts which explicitly instruct the model to change its outputs according to their persona prompts. The purpose of these prompts is to test the LLMs under an extreme case of prompt engineering and are not to be used for generalized usage. The use of these prompts may degrade model performance, increase the risk of stereotyping and produce misleading results.

A Acronyms

IAA Inter-Annotator Agreement
AU A Posteriori Unimodality
UnPol Unnatributtable Polarization
nDFU normalized Distance From Unimodality
NLP Natural Language Processing
GPLv3 GNU General Public Licence v3
AA African American
PC Personal Characteristic
HS Hate Speech

Table 6. Descriptive statistics for the number of annotations per comment, grouped by dataset.

	count	mean	std	min	25%	50%	75%	max
DICES-350	350	123	0	123	123	123	123	123
DICES-990	990	72.8313	1.1652	69	72	73	74	76
POPQUORN	1500	8.6573	0.9087	5	8	9	9	10
Kumar et al. 2021	105910	5.0261	0.3604	5	5	5	5	10
Sap et al. 2022	585	5.6359	0.7713	3	6	6	6	12

Table 7. Subgroup Counts for DICES-990 (left) and DICES-350 (right). "Support" refers to annotation count.

Category	Subgroup	Support
Gender	Woman	36050
	Man	35392
	Nonbinary	331
	Other	330
Race	Other	26394
	Asian	19885
	White	12322
	Latino	7170
	African Am.	6332
Age	Gen. Z	14899
	Millennial	41542
	Gen. X+	15662
Education	College +	64054
	High school -	8049

Category	Subgroup	Support
Gender	Woman	21700
	Man	21350
Race	White	10500
	African Am.	10150
	Asian	9100
	Latino	7700
	Multiracial	5600
Age	1) Gen. Z	19600
	2) Millennial	12600
	3) Gen. X+	10850
Education	College +	26250
	High school -	14350
	Other	2450

SD Standard Deviation
DC Data Coverage
GC Group Coverage
AD Annotation Density

B Exploratory Analysis

The number of annotators per item for all datasets presented in §3 can be found in 8, and descriptive statistics can be found in Table 6. The DICES-990 dataset has exactly 123 annotations per item, while the other datasets exhibit a few variations around the central mean reported in Table 1. Interestingly, the sample used from the Kumar dataset exhibits a few items that vastly exceed the promised 5 number of annotators. We do not include these items, since they are very likely a data error. Tables 7,8,9 show the annotation counts for each PC group in each dataset.

C Apunim Details

C.1 Statistical Estimation

Since annotation histograms may be noisy, we additionally assess whether the observed apunim value could arise by chance. To assess statistical significance, we construct a null distribution of apunim values from the randomized partitions and compare the observed apunim against this distribution using a one-sample Student-t test. Thus, the null

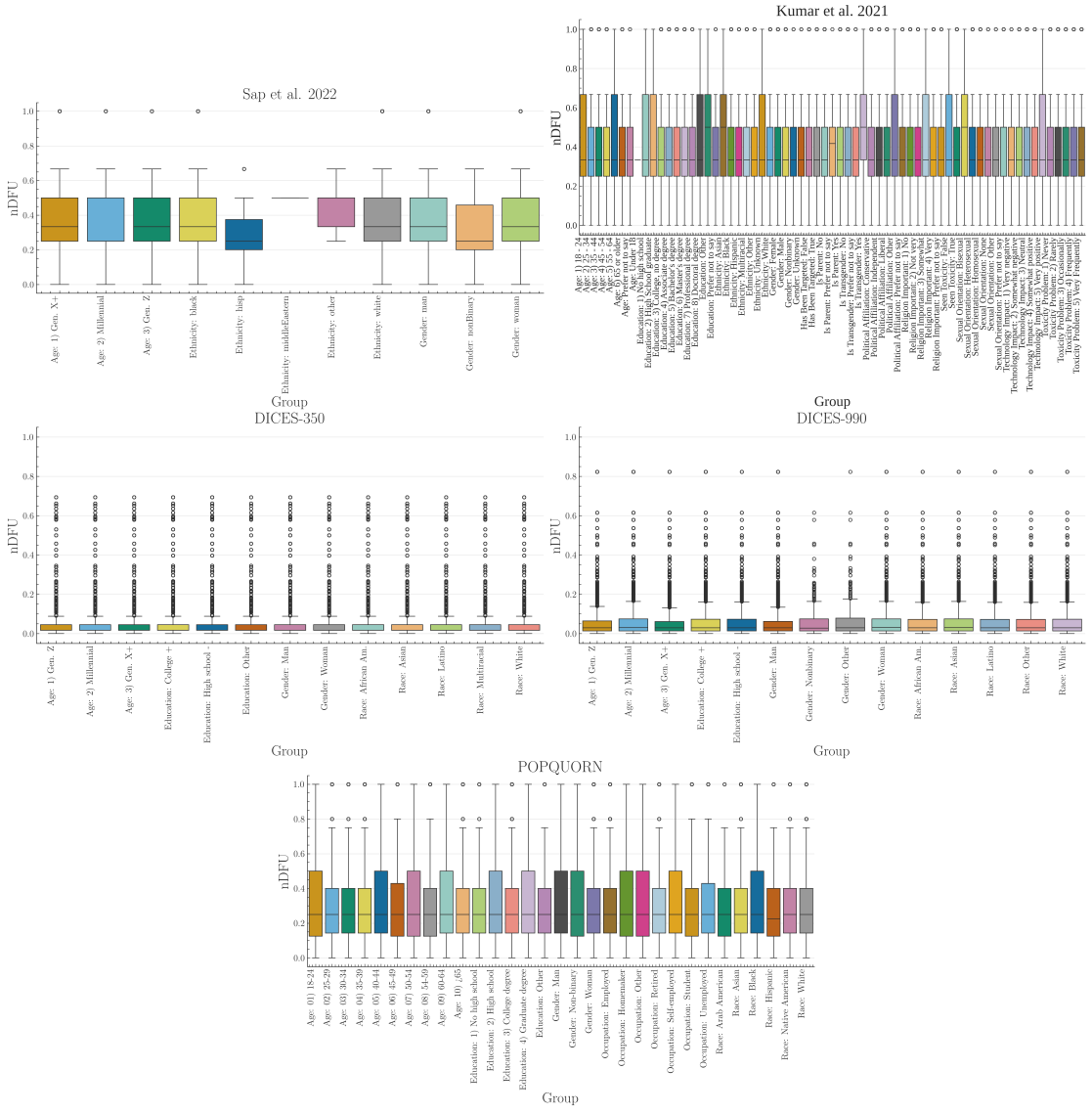


Fig. 7. Boxplots of dataset polarization for the human datasets considered in this paper for all groups in each examined PC dimension.

hypothesis states that the observed polarization is indistinguishable from polarization induced by random annotator assignments:

$$\begin{aligned} H_0 &: \; ap\bar{u}nim_{\text{rand}}(d,g) = apunim(d,g) \\ H_a &: \; ap\bar{u}nim_{\text{rand}}(d,g) \neq apunim(d,g) \end{aligned} \tag{5}$$

where $ap\bar{u}nim_{\text{rand}}(d,g)$ denotes the average apunim values obtained from t randomized annotator partitions.

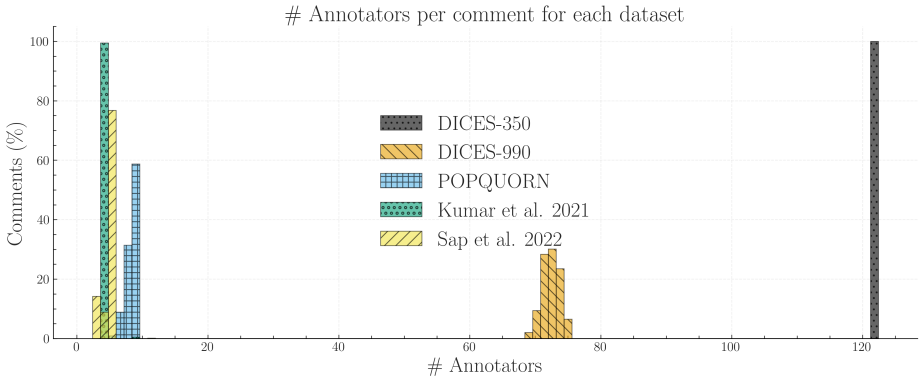


Fig. 8. We calculate the ratio of items for each dataset (y-axis) that had x number of annotators (x-axis). We truncate the x-axis to 130 annotators, disregarding very few items in the Kumar dataset exceeding this threshold (see Table 6), which is likely caused by a data error.

We account for the presence of multiple subgroups in each PC dimension using a multiple-hypothesis correction. Since our test is parametric (App. C.1), it assumes that there exist (1) enough data-points to reliably run the means-test, (2) enough annotations per PC group to estimate nDFUs, (3) the apunim values of the random partitions are independent and identically distributed. Condition (1) can be safely assumed for most datasets, because they feature enough items to reliably assume normal residuals (see §3). We discuss condition (2) in §6. Condition (3) is partly fulfilled; the partitions are identically distributed, but may be dependent on the sample distribution.

Replacing the parametric means test with a non-parametric alternative would relax assumptions about the underlying distribution but would not resolve the potential dependence between the random apunims. We initially attempted to implement a permutation test on the empirical (random apunim) distribution, but this resulted in excessive computational costs.

While the test operates on a single group in principle, in practice we often want to test polarization for all subgroups of a specific dimension. Since we are simultaneously considering multiple hypotheses, we apply a multiple comparison correction to the resulting p-values—specifically the Holms method [22]. The test is parameterized by the confidence level of our test, which is used to tune the strength of the correction; we can increase this value to make our test more conservative towards multiple hypotheses [8]).

C.2 Software

Installation and Usage. We release the `apunim` package, which is a Python library that implements both the nDFU and apunim calculations, as well as its statistical test. The software is available on PyPi We also provide high-level documentation in HTML format that includes an introduction, guide, and full low-level documentation for each of the two provided functions (https://anonymous.4open.science/r/apunim-page).

We use version `1.0.6` of the `apunim` library for our experiments. We use 100 random iterations for the apriori value calculation and the p-value estimation (App. C.1), and set a confidence level of $\alpha = 0.05$. The relative library setup is provided as a `conda` environment file to ensure reproducibility. The code is open-source, licensed under the GNU General Public Licence v3 (GPLv3) and can be found on the project's repository (https://anonymous.4open.science/r/aposteriori-

Table 8. Subgroup Counts for the Sap (left) and POPQUORN (right) datasets. "Support" refers to annotation count.

Category	Subgroup	Support
Age	Gen. Z	252
	Millennial	2259
	Gen. X+	786
Race	White	2168
	Black	1091
	Hisp	32
	Other	5
	MiddleEastern	1
Gender	man	1859
	woman	1412
	nonBinary	26

Category	Subgroup	Count
Gender	Woman	6470
	Man	6166
	Non-binary	350
Race	White	9754
	Black	1685
	Asian	949
	Native American	299
	Hispanic	250
	Arab American	49
Age	18-24	1545
	25-29	1236
	30-34	1494
	35-39	1547
	40-44	1142
	45-49	1091
	50-54	947
	54-59	1793
	60-64	747
	>65	1444
Education	No high school	237
	High school	3934
	College degree	6036
	Graduate degree	2481
	Other	298
Occupation	Student	995
	Homemaker	594
	Retired	1446
	Employed	6325
	Self-employed	1692
	Unemployed	1684
	Other	250

unimodality-E8C1). The library is cross-platform, works for any Python 3 version, and requires very few dependencies (namely `numpy, scipy, statsmodels`).

Implementation Details. By default, the computation of the apunim values happens on a single thread. In cases of serious computational cost, we recommend running the apunim calculation on multiple concurrent processes, since all operations are CPU-bound and thread-safe. This may be useful in cases where there are multiple PC dimensions, each of which is computationally expensive. In order to lower the computational cost required, we re-use the random partitions, which are originally calculated to obtain the apriori polarization values, for the p-value calculations (App. C.1). This means that in our current implementation, the number of groups for estimating apriori polarization, and the number of apunim values used in the p-value calculation have to be the same.

Table 9. Subgroup Counts for the Kumar dataset. "Support" refers to annotation count.

Category	Subgroup	Support
Gender	Female	8011
	Male	6832
	Unknown	124
	Nonbinary	93
Ethnicity	White	10699
	Black	1940
	Asian	862
	Multiracial	664
	Hispanic	418
	Other	247
	Unknown	230
Age	Under 18	3
	18 - 24	1711
	25 - 34	5969
	35 - 44	3785
	45 - 54	1977
	55 - 64	1101
	65 or older	471
	N/A	43
Education	No high school	71
	High School	1353
	College	3090
	Associate's	1676
	Bachelor's	6071
	Master's	2261
	Professional	236
	Doctoral	198
	N/A	71
	Other	32
Sexual Orient.	Heterosexual	12391
	Bisexual	1665
	Homosexual	515
	N/A	302
	Other	131
Is Trans	No	14549
	Yes	363
	N/A	148
Politics	Liberal	5997
	Independent	4143
	Conservative	3981
	N/A	609
	Other	330
Is Parent	Yes	7889
	No	7015
	N/A	156
Tech Impact	Very negative	149
	Somewhat negative	1411
	Neutral	1905
	Somewhat positive	7690
	Very positive	3905
Tox Problem	Never	869
	Rarely	2485
	Occasionally	5307
	Frequently	4441
	Very Frequently	1958
Rel Important	No	4735
	Not very	1808
	Somewhat	3548
	Very	4741
	N/A	228
Seen Toxicity	True	11505
	False	3555
Targeted	False	10741
	True	4319

While the library efficiently handles large numbers of annotators through vectorized operations, performance degrades significantly when processing a high volume of items, particularly when annotators belong to multiple distinct groups. For instance, while experiments across all datasets in §3 complete within a minute, the Kumar dataset necessitates approximately one hour of computation using commercial hardware. Furthermore, the annotator variance analysis detailed in Fig. 5 required over ten hours. While this latter time requirement is anticipated due to the inherently demanding nature and non-standard application of our library, it demonstrates the existence of a potential scaling bottleneck. The same applies to a lesser extent for the subsampling experiments on the DICES datasets, taking collectively three hours of computation.

We hypothesize that this bottleneck is likely caused by repeated creation of numpy arrays, resulting in repeated memory allocations for each subgroup, in each item, for each PC dimension. We plan on profiling and addressing it in the

next releases of our software. Until then, we suggest either using multiprocessing for each PC subgroup, or running the different experiments in parallel (indeed, we use the `gnu-parallel` package [47] for our own experiments). We also note that the Kumar dataset also requires substantial RAM resources, estimated around 42–46GB of dedicated RAM should the whole dataset be considered (this is not a requirement for loading the sample used in this study). The CPU-bound experiments require approximately 3 hours to run, assuming a computer capable of efficient multiprocessing.

Finally, we note that in Fig. 5, we removed values where there was a lack of items annotated by the specified number of annotators (e.g., only 7% of items in DICES-990 were annotated by more than 73 annotators—see App. B).

C.3 Design Decisions

Defining Apriori Polarization. In §5, we explained how our methodology needs to compare the polarization between the set of all annotations and those made by a specific group g. Direct comparisons are not advisable, since we would be comparing statistics between a set and its subset—in this case, standard practice dictates comparing the subset with its complement; i.e., the in-group vs. the out-group instead of the in-group vs. all the annotations. However, this also would not work; if we apply the subset-vs-complement method in the example of Fig. 4, left, we would end up subtracting the nDFUs of men and women, which are similar as they are both unimodal distributions, falsely concluding that there is no polarization present.

Filtering Ineligible items. Because *apunim* is fundamentally designed to quantify polarization, we exclude items that exhibit no measurable polarization ($nDFU(c) = 0$). Furthermore, we also exclude items annotated exclusively by a single group (i.e., items where there are no two groups with at least three annotators each), since we require valid histograms for the non-parametric estimation of nDFU (see Eq. 1). This is an unfortunately common scenario, since many NLP datasets feature only $5 - 6$ annotations per item. In a best-case scenario of 5 annotators split evenly between two groups, we would get a 3-2 split.

D Exploring UnPol

Why Does it Exist? Unlike disagreement, UnPol does not provide any information, but rather represents noise or uncertainty translated in terms of polarization. In order to minimize it, we need to find its cause. Since the DICES datasets are the only ones without *any* items with UnPol leads us to two hypotheses:

Hypothesis 1 (Low annotator count). *A low number of annotators per item may provide our model with insufficient information.*

Hypothesis 2 (Inaccessible groups). *UnPol may arise from the presence of partially represented groups within the annotator pool which may go undetected if they are represented by only one or two annotators, as nDFU is undefined for these groups.*

Both of these explanations are plausible and reflect known limitations of most NLP datasets. Unfortunately, we can not confirm any of these hypotheses.

Why Do DICES not Exhibit UnPol? In order to investigate whether the numerous annotators per items can explain the lack of UnPol in the DICES datasets (§4) we gradually subsample the annotators for each item randomly with replacement, starting from five annotators per item, and scaling up to the full complement of annotators in the dataset with a step of two. For each such step, we choose ten annotator samples and compute the maximum UnPol across all

Table 10. Sample of comments from the Sap dataset and their UnPol. Note that unambiguously toxic comments can be assigned with zero UnPol, while more nuanced cases tend to have higher values.

Content Warning: Slurs, offensive, toxic and hateful speech.	
Comment	UnPol
The minks mentioned in the headline are indeed "rising" from where they were based, but that is due to them being buried in shallow mass graves (Africa) and filling with gas that causes them to rise out. Rest assured, they're still very much dead, thankfully!.	1
There should be such thing as a b[redacted]ch resistance for us women	1
There's a big difference between being a b[redacted]ch and being a woman	1
i just watched a video of @joisnotonfire being an annoying h[redacted]e on skype i'm laughing	1
n[redacted]as love to commit crime	1
I swear to God above I love ya and when ya be with this brotha, I swear I love you my bro as long as you not a n[redacted]a	0.5
I will become a cold ass b[redacted]ch because of my treatment	0.5
I would happily lay out a n[redacted]a	0.5
Shoot yourself in the head you hypersensitive fuckin b[redacted]ch.	0.5
not all women are b[redacted]ches, but all b[redacted]ches are women	0.5
"you ugly b[redacted]ch!!!"- that seems to be my real name these days"	0
"I am happy to report that drowning does kill this demonic entity. Oh holy are the waters of Chernarus!"" Omg, DED ;)"	0
"Let them praise the name of the LORD: for his name alone is excellent; his glory is above the earth and heaven."" Psalms 148:13 #Bible"	0
someone plz get this n[redacted]er some help. He's playing up like mad	0
stop talking you fucking n[redacted]er !	0

runs. Even with annotator counts similar to the Kumar and DICES datasets, UnPol remains zero, suggesting that the absence of UnPol can not be attributed to annotator number alone—rather, it is plausibly a pattern attributable to the DICES datasets themselves. This kind of analysis may be used in the exploratory phase of dataset selection in order to filter out datasets without enough group-specific subjectivity.

How Does it Look Like? Table 10 shows a random sample of items taken from the Sap dataset and their respective UnPol values (§4). Note that explicitly toxic or racist items tend to have UnPol values of zero, alongside clearly unproblematic items. Inversely, more ambiguous and less comprehensible items tend to have larger UnPol values. This pattern may suggest that UnPol may be tied to the overall ambiguity of the statements, especially in cases where items may either be interpreted as very toxic, or non-toxic, which agrees with the overall goal of nDFU (§2). We include the UnPol values for each individual item for all four datasets in the supplementary material.

E Experiments

E.1 Synthetic Examples

This appendix details the synthetic experiments used to illustrate the functionality and behavior of nDFU. In all simulations, the bin size is set to $N_{bins} = 10$.

Disagreement vs. Polarization. To explore the relationship between annotation polarization and disagreement in Fig. 1, we constructed a 2×2 matrix of synthetic datasets, each drawing from a pool of $N_{annotators} = 100$. Polarization is

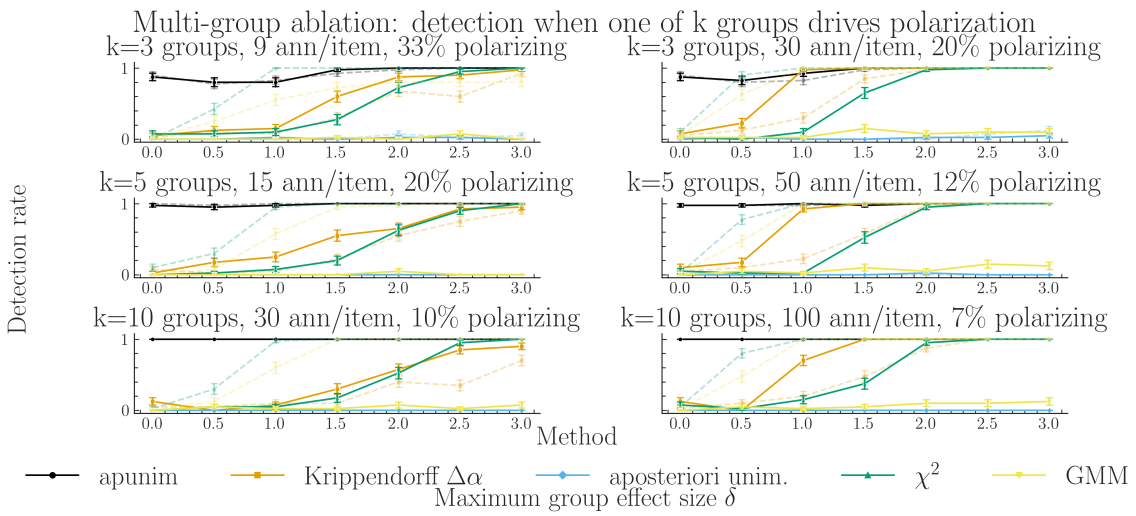


Fig. 9. Polarization group attribution on synthetic distributions. Bars indicate standard error. The setup is identical to the one used for Fig. 2, although in these experiments we consider multiple k annotator groups for each item. Dashed lines show the results of a simplified polarization setup, where polarization always has the same direction.

simulated by defining a minority group, which constitutes 20% of the total annotators (n_special = 20). These minority annotators are assigned a targeted mean shift (mean_shift = 1) from the base distribution. The base variance for these distributions is set at variance = 0.3. Different types of distributions (unimodal, bimodal, multimodal, uniform) are achieved by controlling the base_means and applying variance multipliers (e.g., variance × 3 for multimodal).

Single-Item Polarization. We simulate the distribution of toxicity annotations in Fig. 4, left, across two demographic groups (Men and Women). The distribution of Men's scores is modeled using a truncated normal distribution with loc = 2 and scale = 1.3, while Women's scores are modeled with loc = 8 and scale = 1.3. The combined dataset, representing all annotations, is used to demonstrate the impact of population weighting on the overall nDFU score. The sample size for each group in this visualization is $N_{annotators} = 50$.

Discussion-Level Polarization. We examine nDFU scores for three specific textual examples presented in Fig. 3. For the individual items, $N_{annotators} = 200$ for each group. In the first case (misogynist item), Men's scores are modeled with loc = 6, while Women's scores are modeled with loc = 2. In the second case (misandrist item), the roles are reversed. The third visualization combines distributions for men and women derived from the respective single-item distributions.

E.2 Ablations

Does Apunim Work for More than Two Groups? We repeat the experiment comparing apunim to prior methodologies shown in Fig. 2 but generalized across multiple groups. As shown in Fig. 9, apunim stays competitive even in the presence of multiple annotator groups. Note the increased efficiency of many methods when polarization is unidirectional. This pattern indicates that the challenges of bidirectional polarization severely limiting prior approaches may be generalizable to more than two groups.

Table 11. Comparison of Apunim values across different sample sizes (1k, 3k, 10k, 30k) for the Kumar dataset.

		1000	3000	10000	30000
	PC				
Age	1) 18 - 24	0.014	-0.017	-0.037	-0.016
	2) 25 - 34	-0.003	-0.000	0.000	0.000
	3) 35 - 44	0.000	-0.011	-0.001	-0.001
	4) 45 - 54	0.022	0.033	0.013	0.003
	5) 55 - 64	0.000	0.000	-0.057	0.001
	6) 65 or older	—	—	—	0.948
Education	2) High School graduate	0.000	0.000	-0.005	0.014
	3) College, no degree	0.010	0.014	0.010	0.006
	4) Associate degree	0.000	0.000	0.005	0.009
	5) Bachelor's degree	0.001	-0.000	-0.001	-0.000
	6) Master's degree	0.000	-0.006	0.004	-0.000
Ethnicity	Asian	-0.000	0.000	0.011	0.007
	Black	0.000	-0.024	-0.004	-0.012
	Hispanic	—	—	0.000	-0.099
	Multiracial	0.000	0.000	0.000	0.000
	Other	—	—	—	-0.306
	White	0.000	-0.000	-0.000	0.000
Gender	Female	0.001	0.000	0.002	0.001
	Male	0.001	-0.004	-0.002	-0.001
Has Been Targeted	False	0.001	0.000	-0.000	0.000
	True	-0.009	-0.015	-0.003	-0.002
Is Parent	No	-0.002	0.002	0.001	0.001
	Prefer not to say	—	—	1.000	0.000
	Yes	-0.000	0.000	-0.000	0.000
Is Transgender	No	0.000	0.000	0.000	0.000
Political Affiliation	Conservative	-0.013	0.003	-0.003	-0.002
	Independent	0.000	-0.001	0.001	0.002
	Liberal	-0.001	0.006	0.001	0.001
	Other	—	0.000	0.000	0.000
	Prefer not to say	—	—	0.000	0.022
Religion Important	1) No	0.002	0.004	0.002	0.001
	2) Not very	0.000	-0.006	0.010	0.006
	3) Somewhat	0.000	0.002	0.003	-0.002
	4) Very	0.000	-0.003	-0.003	-0.002

Continued on next page

Table 11. Comparison of Apunim values across different sample sizes (1k, 3k, 10k, 30k) for the Kumar dataset.

		1000	3000	10000	30000
	PC				
Seen Toxicity	False	-0.007	0.002	-0.001	-0.001
	True	-0.001	0.000	0.001	0.000
Sexual Orientation	Bisexual	-0.068	-0.029	-0.040	-0.013
	Heterosexual	-0.001	-0.000	-0.000	0.000
	Homosexual	—	—	0.000	0.053
	Prefer not to say	—	—	—	0.370
Technology Impact	2) Somewhat negative	0.000	0.000	0.000	0.003
	3) Neutral	0.124	0.037	-0.014	0.000
	4) Somewhat positive	0.004	0.001	-0.000	0.001
	5) Very positive	-0.015	-0.004	-0.004	-0.003
Toxicity Problem	1) Never	0.000	0.000	-0.037	-0.081
	2) Rarely	0.000	0.000	0.003	-0.001
	3) Occasionally	0.000	-0.004	-0.003	-0.001
	4) Frequently	0.000	0.000	-0.001	-0.000
	5) Very Frequently	0.000	-0.002	0.030	0.015

How Does Dataset Size Influence Apunim? Since our approach was designed for the small-scale datasets common in NLP, we were cautious when testing it on the massive Kumar dataset. Because of the data volume, we analyzed various smaller samples (1,000, 3,000, 10,000, and 30,000 items), shown in Table 11. Sample size does not seem to have a consistent effect on apunim values, other than large splits uncovering significant polarization effects in sparsely populated groups (e.g., 65+ yo. in *Age*, "Prefer Not to Say" in *Sexual Orientation*, "Never" , "Very Frequently" in *Toxicity Problem*). The apunim direction stays broadly the same. We also test whether the results in Table 3 are an artifact of the dataset split, because of the small sample size used in the study. We repeat the apunim experiment with ten different subsets of the same dataset and record their apunim values, shown in Fig. 10. We find that most apunim values are stable, save for "Never" in *Toxicity Problem*, "Heterosexual" in *Sexual Orientation* and "Neutral" in *Technology Impact*.

How Does Sample Selection Influence Apunim? Astute readers may notice that some variability does exist across differently sized samples for the same examined groups, where for example the sign of the apunim value may switch. We note that the statistically significant values (bold rows) change signs only when the apunim value approaches zero in the largest samples. Thus, the results are not inverted, but rather pushed towards zero. In order to verify that this variability is caused by the sample size, and not by different samples being drawn, we execute a further ablation study. Specifically, we execute the apunim study on the 3000-sized sample of the dataset, using different subsets of the Kumar dataset. The results can be found in Fig. 10, where we note that variability is not an issue, except for a couple of cases. These cases seem to represent sparse annotator groups, where missing a few items may genuinely change the value of the apunim metric. These groups however are largely not detected by apunim as significant either way (see Table 3).

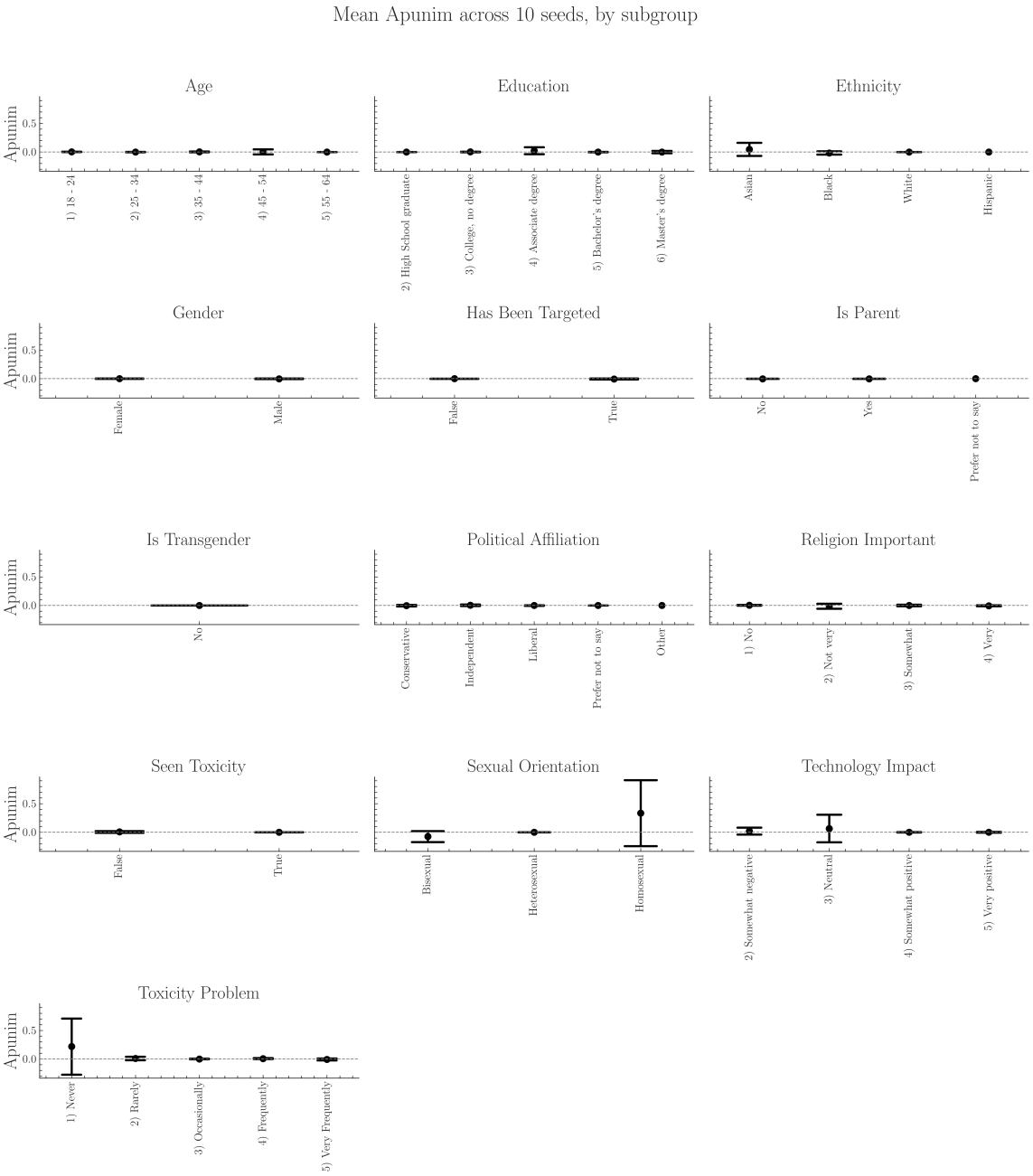


Fig. 10. Apunim values on the Kumar dataset ($n_{samples}$ = 1000) across ten runs with different subsets. Black bars indicate two SDs. PC dimensions with many groups are more volatile, although all dimensions broadly keep the same apunim sign across subsets.

F LLM Annotation Procedure

F.1 Models Used

We use only open-source models, as proprietary models such as OpenAI's GPT-5 yield much less reproducible results [5]. Furthermore, the use of open-source models requires much fewer resources, enabling research on this task with a less demanding budget, as well as scalable deployment in real-world settings [43]. It is also worth noting that since the datasets used are not publicly licensed, we can not risk leaking the data contained within to proprietary models. Generally, the use of local models protects the personal data of the users contained in our datasets, ensures that our research can be replicated in domains where anonymity must be maintained, and renders our work compatible with existing legislation [12, 13]. Table 12 shows details on the LLMs used for this study. We specifically use 4-bit quantized versions from the `unsloth huggingface` repository.

Table 12. LLMs used in this study.

Family	Version	#Params
OLMo [19]	2 (0325)	32B
Qwen [58]	2.5	32B
OLMo [37]	3	7B
Qwen [58]	2.5	7B
LLaMa [18]	3.1	8B

F.2 Experimental Setup

Since each of the datasets in §3 was annotated using different annotation guidelines and targets we use different instruction prompts for each dataset. The "default" annotation prompt is directly extracted from the studies in the case of Sap and Kumar, and inferred from the instruction guidelines used in the DICES datasets with minor modifications. We use standard persona prompting procedures sampled randomly from the available PC dimensions in each respective dataset. Six LLM annotators are selected for each item and model.

The prompts used in the ablation study were provided by a GPT-5 and a local Gemma-4 (quantized) model by providing the original prompt and instructing it to produce four variants. The tested prompts use different methods to restrict the model's behavior. The initial prompts ("*Persona*"require the model to adopt a persona's viewpoint to judge the comment. Other prompts ("*direct*") treat the persona's characteristics as an absolute, non-negotiable rule that overrides standard moderation guidelines. Another approach ("single") compels the model to perform a persona-based check before submitting its final rating. The most aggressive prompts ("stereotype") force the model into extreme decision spaces. The full main and ablation annotation prompts can be found in App. H.

We use a single Quadro RTX 6000 GPU for tasks requiring small (7-8B) models and two such GPUs for the rest. The annotation task, including ablations, requires approximately 300 hours of computation to complete. We use the `transformers` library to load and manage the LLMs. We release the relevant code in the supplementary material. Our codebase is platform-independent except for three high-level bash scripts and a full environment file is included for reproduction.

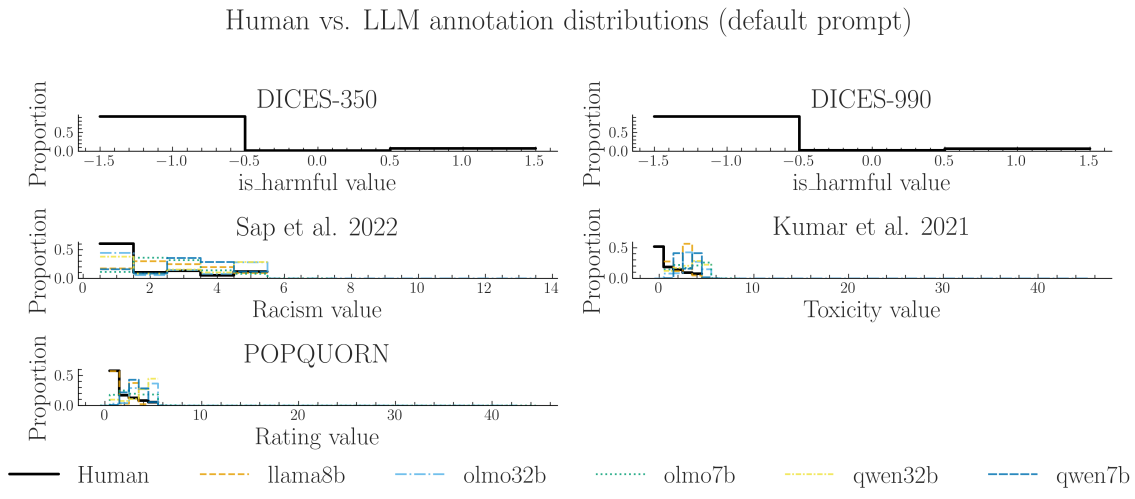


Fig. 11. Annotation frequencies for humans and each LLM in the primary annotation task using the default prompt.

F.3 Exploratory Analysis

Fig. 11 shows the different annotation frequencies of LLMs and human annotators in the same dataset split. Across all four datasets, we observe a consistent mismatch between human and LLM annotation distributions. For the DICES-350 and DICES-990 harmfulness tasks, human annotations are heavily concentrated at the lowest harmfulness value, whereas most LLMs assign substantially more probability to moderate and high harmfulness values. A similar pattern appears in the Sap et al. [46] racism dataset: human judgments are concentrated at low racism scores, while LLMs produce broader distributions with considerably more mass at higher scores, particularly values 4–5. The [26] toxicity results show the same general trend, with humans assigning most probability to zero toxicity while LLMs distribute their predictions across higher toxicity levels, often peaking around values 2–4. Importantly, the magnitude of this discrepancy varies across models; some LLMs are closer to the human distribution, while others show substantially stronger shifts toward higher scores.

We also investigate whether LLM annotations include any UnPol. Fig. 6 shows that UnPol is significantly smaller than in human annotations. Adversarial prompts seem to consistently increase it, although it does not approach human levels. It is also notable that as with LLM apunim values (next section), UnPol seems to be primarily model-dependent.

F.4 Annotation Ablations

We examine the following conditions for selecting models and datasets for our LLM annotation experiment. All ablation experiments use a sampled 20% fraction of the full LLM annotation dataset used in the main text.

The LLMs should be consistent given the same prompt. While we have fixed all relevant seeds, it is possible that generation deviates across repeated model prompting given the same input [5]. We check this condition by providing the model with the main annotation prompt (see App. H) five times and find that generation is indeed deterministic under our setup for all models (Table 13).

Table 13. Consistency (Krippendorff's α, ordinal) of each model with itself across repeated runs of the same (default) prompt.

Dataset	Model	Runs	Items	Krippendorff's alpha
DICES-350	llama8b	5	210	1.0000
DICES-350	olmo32b	5	209	1.0000
DICES-350	olmo7b	5	210	1.0000
DICES-350	qwen32b	5	210	1.0000
DICES-350	qwen7b	5	210	1.0000
DICES-990	llama8b	5	594	1.0000
DICES-990	olmo32b	5	594	1.0000
DICES-990	olmo7b	5	594	1.0000
DICES-990	qwen32b	5	594	1.0000
DICES-990	qwen7b	5	594	1.0000
Sap et al. 2022	llama8b	5	287	1.0000
Sap et al. 2022	olmo32b	5	343	1.0000
Sap et al. 2022	olmo7b	5	338	1.0000
Sap et al. 2022	qwen32b	5	348	1.0000
Sap et al. 2022	qwen7b	5	348	1.0000
Kumar et al. 2021	llama8b	5	458	1.0000
Kumar et al. 2021	olmo32b	5	599	1.0000
Kumar et al. 2021	olmo7b	5	600	1.0000
Kumar et al. 2021	qwen32b	5	600	1.0000
Kumar et al. 2021	qwen7b	5	600	1.0000
POPQUORN	llama8b	5	170	1.0000
POPQUORN	olmo32b	5	896	1.0000
POPQUORN	olmo7b	5	883	1.0000
POPQUORN	qwen32b	5	900	1.0000
POPQUORN	qwen7b	5	900	1.0000

The LLMs should be prompt insensitive. Small changes in the prompt have been shown to drastically affect LLM output in some tasks depending on the experimental setup [42]. In order to verify whether any models are unreliable under our setup, we create two alternative formulations of each prompt without a change in substance using a GPT-5 model (free version), whose outputs we manually verified (see App. H). Table 14 shows that while most LLMs are relatively robust to changes in formulation, the smaller ones (OLMo-7B and LLaMa-8B) are not. They are thus excluded from the annotation study.

The annotation guidelines should be unambiguous. The studies that provided the datasets used in our work (see §3) do not include LLM annotation, nor equivalent LLM prompts, which meant we had to generate them from the human annotation guidelines ourselves. This was not a problem in the case of the Sap and Kumar datasets, since the annotation guidelines were short, simple and required minimal edits to be transformed into LLM annotation guidelines. However, the DICES datasets use poorly documented guidelines and the target label we used is an aggregation of multiple annotation tasks. For these reasons the prompt creation is non-trivial and prone to errors. Indeed, Table 15 shows that inter-model agreement is extremely low for the DICES datasets, even when we remove the sensitive models (Table 16). Given that the DICES datasets are (1) problematic w.r.t. inherent polarization (see App. E.1), (2) conditioned on several dozen annotations per item (3) difficult to find reliable annotation prompts for LLMs, we decided to exclude them from the annotation study.

Table 14. Consistency (Krippendorff's α, ordinal) of each model with itself across the three paraphrased prompt variants.

Dataset	Model	Variants	Items	Krippendorff's alpha
DICES-350	llama8b	3	210	0.0372
DICES-350	olmo32b	3	210	0.0253
DICES-350	olmo7b	3	210	0.1701
DICES-350	qwen32b	3	210	0.0044
DICES-350	qwen7b	3	210	-0.2016
DICES-990	llama8b	3	594	-0.0310
DICES-990	olmo32b	3	594	0.2378
DICES-990	olmo7b	3	594	0.0594
DICES-990	qwen32b	3	594	0.1905
DICES-990	qwen7b	3	594	0.1101
Sap et al. 2022	llama8b	3	336	0.3863
Sap et al. 2022	olmo32b	3	347	0.8579
Sap et al. 2022	olmo7b	3	348	0.3025
Sap et al. 2022	qwen32b	3	348	0.9732
Sap et al. 2022	qwen7b	3	348	0.8625
Kumar et al. 2021	llama8b	3	594	0.0667
Kumar et al. 2021	olmo32b	3	600	0.5169
Kumar et al. 2021	olmo7b	3	600	0.0547
Kumar et al. 2021	qwen32b	3	600	0.9003
Kumar et al. 2021	qwen7b	3	600	0.2496
POPQUORN	llama8b	3	885	0.0175
POPQUORN	olmo32b	3	900	0.5657
POPQUORN	olmo7b	3	900	0.1038
POPQUORN	qwen32b	3	900	0.8381
POPQUORN	qwen7b	3	900	0.2747

Table 15. Consistency (Krippendorff's α, ordinal) between LLMs given the same (default) prompt, per dataset.

Dataset	Prompt	Models	Items	Krippendorff's alpha
Sap et al. 2022	default	5	11700	0.4616
Kumar et al. 2021	default	5	20000	0.0644
POPQUORN	default	5	30000	0.1002

Table 16. Consistency (Krippendorff's α, ordinal) between LLMs given the same (default) prompt, per dataset, excluding the following models: llama8b, olmo7b.

Dataset	Prompt	Models	Items	Krippendorff's alpha
Sap et al. 2022	default	3	11700	0.6829
Kumar et al. 2021	default	3	20000	0.3015
POPQUORN	default	3	30000	0.2548

F.5 LLM Annotation Results

Apunim Analysis. Tables 17,18,19 show the apunim results for the LLM annotation task on the Kumar, Sap and POPQUORN datasets respectively. Apunim values are largely model-dependent, but no other concrete pattern can be discerned.

Table 17. Aposteriori unimodality results for the LLM annotations of the Kumar et al. 2021 dataset, across instruction prompts. $^{*}p < 0.05$, $^{**}p < 0.01$, $^{***}p < 0.001$.

PC	Value	Model	Default	Stereotype	Persona	Single	Direct
Age	1) 18 - 24	olmo32b	—	0.090	—	—	-0.017
		qwen32b	-0.261	0.177	—	-0.018	-0.073
		qwen7b	0.024	-0.075***	-0.000	0.042	0.077***
	2) 25 - 34	olmo32b	—	0.068	—	—	0.051**
		qwen32b	0.289	0.105	—	-0.046*	-0.304
		qwen7b	0.052***	0.112***	0.082***	0.118***	0.074***
	3) 35 - 44	olmo32b	0.071	—	—	—	-0.024
		qwen32b	0.112	0.122	-0.213	0.058*	0.101
		qwen7b	-0.004	0.008	0.103***	-0.027	-0.000
	4) 45 - 54	olmo32b	-0.169	-0.254	—	—	-0.012
		qwen32b	-0.020	0.153	—	0.047*	-0.081
		qwen7b	0.113***	-0.040	-0.059	0.007	0.070***
	5) 55 - 64	olmo32b	0.087	0.089	—	—	-0.016
		qwen32b	0.152	0.084	0.527	0.059*	0.077
		qwen7b	0.006	0.016	0.023	-0.053**	-0.006
	6) 65 or older	olmo32b	-0.123	0.333	—	—	0.005
		qwen32b	0.173	-0.210	—	0.061*	0.146
		qwen7b	0.100***	0.086***	0.034	0.009	0.079***
	Prefer not to say	olmo32b	0.154	0.099	—	—	0.011
		qwen32b	-0.241	0.102	0.097	0.017	-0.174
		qwen7b	0.031*	0.002	-0.017	-0.012	0.001
	Under 18	olmo32b	0.023	-0.127	—	—	-0.018
		qwen32b	-0.219	-0.110	-0.225	-0.062*	0.005
		qwen7b	0.011	-0.031	-0.021	0.057**	-0.005
Education	1) No high school	olmo32b	0.266	—	—	—	0.068***
		qwen32b	-0.180	-0.170	0.399	-0.042	-0.106
		qwen7b	-0.000	0.088**	0.003	0.057*	0.014
	2) High School graduate	olmo32b	—	—	—	—	0.022
		qwen32b	0.087	-0.006	0.307	-0.076*	0.212
		qwen7b	-0.014	0.082**	0.052	-0.002	0.038
	3) College, no degree	olmo32b	0.299	—	—	—	-0.052*
		qwen32b	0.199	0.045	—	-0.044	0.137
		qwen7b	0.016	-0.068*	-0.014	-0.031	-0.033
	4) Associate degree	olmo32b	—	0.079	—	—	-0.053**
		qwen32b	0.626	0.132	—	0.133***	0.156*
		qwen7b	0.035	-0.018	0.017	-0.047	0.045*
	5) Bachelor's degree	olmo32b	—	0.141	—	—	-0.108***
		qwen32b	0.773	-0.353	-1.000	0.036	-0.097
		qwen7b	-0.003	0.016	0.064*	0.031	0.071***
	6) Master's degree	olmo32b	—	—	—	—	0.097***
		qwen32b	—	0.242	—	0.034	0.319
		qwen7b	0.037*	0.009	0.015	-0.027	-0.008
	7) Professional degree	olmo32b	—	—	—	—	-0.009
		qwen32b	0.001	0.158	0.268	-0.093**	-0.387**
		qwen7b	-0.028	0.030	0.050	0.055*	-0.006
	8) Doctoral degree	olmo32b	-0.214	-0.040	—	—	-0.032
		qwen32b	-0.371	-0.007	—	0.003	-0.223
		qwen7b	-0.007	-0.086***	0.032	0.019	0.021

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Table 17. Aposteriori unimodality results for the LLM annotations of the Kumar et al. 2021 dataset, across instruction prompts. $^{*}p < 0.05$, $^{**}p < 0.01$, $^{***}p < 0.001$.

PC	Value	Model	Default	Stereotype	Persona	Single	Direct
	Other	olmo32b	0.198	-0.039	—	—	-0.010
		qwen32b	0.188	0.085	—	0.049	-0.132
		qwen7b	-0.042*	-0.017	-0.095***	0.061*	-0.077***
	Prefer not to say	olmo32b	-0.187	-0.242	—	—	-0.043*
		qwen32b	0.198	-0.122	—	0.057*	0.014
		qwen7b	-0.003	0.020	-0.130***	-0.095**	0.043
Ethnicity	Asian	olmo32b	-0.231	0.082	—	—	-0.022
		qwen32b	0.216	-0.106	—	-0.032	0.033
		qwen7b	-0.034*	0.055*	0.042	0.010	0.022
	Black	olmo32b	0.091	-0.187	—	—	-0.072***
		qwen32b	-0.282	-0.063	—	-0.045	0.056
		qwen7b	-0.007	0.009	0.003	0.030	0.021
	Hispanic	olmo32b	0.075	-0.387	—	—	-0.001
		qwen32b	-0.043	-0.116	—	0.022	-0.001
		qwen7b	0.017	0.032	0.022	0.001	0.021
	Multiracial	olmo32b	0.095	0.333	—	—	0.055***
		qwen32b	0.021	0.052	0.142	0.023	-0.118
		qwen7b	0.019	0.001	-0.005	-0.039	-0.018
	Other	olmo32b	0.061	0.056	—	—	-0.001
		qwen32b	0.076	0.228*	—	0.066**	0.075
		qwen7b	0.027*	-0.021	0.008	-0.063**	0.003
	Unknown	olmo32b	-1.000	0.017	—	—	-0.026
		qwen32b	-0.197	-0.117	0.184	0.013	0.037
		qwen7b	-0.003	0.014	-0.004	0.033	-0.027
	White	olmo32b	0.085	0.345	—	—	0.032*
		qwen32b	-0.301	-0.035	—	-0.034	0.063
		qwen7b	0.022	-0.055*	-0.018	0.006	-0.010
Gender	Female	olmo32b	0.063**	-0.075	—	—	0.003
		qwen32b	-0.177	-0.246***	—	0.007	-0.051
		qwen7b	-0.012	0.061***	0.028	0.006	-0.011
	Male	olmo32b	0.074	-0.114	—	—	0.027*
		qwen32b	-0.043	0.052	-0.001	-0.042*	0.030
		qwen7b	0.013	-0.099***	-0.017	0.001	-0.017
	Nonbinary	olmo32b	-0.341**	0.051	—	—	0.003
		qwen32b	0.151	0.092*	-0.383	0.085***	0.024
		qwen7b	-0.009	0.024	0.039*	0.001	0.025
	Unknown	olmo32b	-0.013	0.144	—	—	-0.027*
		qwen32b	-0.057	0.091*	0.281	-0.021	-0.037
		qwen7b	0.019	0.075***	-0.012	-0.024	0.021
Has Been Targeted	False	olmo32b	0.029*	0.049	—	—	0.024*
		qwen32b	-0.112	0.072*	0.140	-0.007	0.067
		qwen7b	0.082***	-0.033	-0.042**	-0.059***	-0.002
	True	olmo32b	-0.009	-0.020	—	—	-0.022*
		qwen32b	0.130	-0.106*	-0.114	-0.014	-0.032
		qwen7b	-0.057***	0.052**	0.055**	0.070***	0.001
Is Parent	No	olmo32b	0.013	0.021	—	—	-0.010
		qwen32b	0.012	-0.140*	-0.296	0.010	-0.118
		qwen7b	0.042***	-0.014	0.014	-0.013	0.042**
	Prefer not to say	olmo32b	-0.011	-0.008	—	—	0.001
		qwen32b	0.067	0.002	0.469	-0.022	0.093
		qwen7b	-0.021	-0.011	-0.039	-0.045**	-0.026
	Yes	olmo32b	0.002	0.042	—	—	-0.003
		qwen32b	0.084	0.113*	-0.180	-0.008	0.014
		qwen7b	0.006	0.053**	0.010	0.042**	0.000
Is Transgender	No	olmo32b	0.060*	0.080	—	—	-0.014

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Table 17. Aposteriori unimodality results for the LLM annotations of the Kumar et al. 2021 dataset, across instruction prompts. $^{*}p < 0.05$, $^{**}p < 0.01$, $^{***}p < 0.001$.

PC	Value	Model	Default	Stereotype	Persona	Single	Direct
		qwen32b	-0.051	0.179***	-0.109	0.007	0.131*
		qwen7b	-0.027*	0.058***	0.022	0.006	0.017
	Prefer not to say	olmo32b	0.084*	-0.146	—	—	0.043***
		qwen32b	0.255	-0.244***	0.316	0.017	0.090
		qwen7b	-0.047***	0.008	-0.025	-0.000	0.016
	Yes	olmo32b	-0.062**	0.014	—	—	0.003
		qwen32b	-0.245	-0.072	0.133	-0.020	0.148*
		qwen7b	0.058***	-0.066***	0.018	0.001	0.018
Political Affiliation	Conservative	olmo32b	0.095	0.093	—	—	0.014
		qwen32b	0.006	-0.300*	0.581	-0.016	0.020
		qwen7b	0.061***	-0.078***	-0.003	0.014	0.024
	Independent	olmo32b	-0.119	-0.057	—	—	0.011
		qwen32b	-0.062	-0.109*	-0.348	0.026	-0.049
		qwen7b	0.000	0.008	0.007	0.015	0.008
	Liberal	olmo32b	0.083	0.088	—	—	-0.029*
		qwen32b	0.185	0.221**	-1.000	0.025	0.061
		qwen7b	0.015	0.011	0.042*	0.038*	0.006
	Other	olmo32b	0.078**	-0.149	—	—	-0.052***
		qwen32b	0.102	-0.128*	0.316	0.009	0.005
		qwen7b	-0.005	0.067***	-0.041*	0.021	0.015
	Prefer not to say	olmo32b	-0.137*	0.151	—	—	0.015
		qwen32b	-0.242	0.051	0.342	0.019	0.031
		qwen7b	-0.055***	0.005	-0.004	-0.011	-0.027
Religion Important	1) No	olmo32b	0.093	0.095	—	—	-0.009
		qwen32b	0.212	0.006	—	0.028	0.182
		qwen7b	-0.025*	-0.004	-0.016	0.024	-0.024
	2) Not very	olmo32b	0.093	0.052	—	—	0.002
		qwen32b	0.138	-0.159*	0.097	0.028	-0.028
		qwen7b	0.023*	0.088***	0.052**	0.086***	0.024
	3) Somewhat	olmo32b	-0.462	-0.074***	—	—	0.042***
		qwen32b	0.070	0.125*	—	0.020	-0.042
		qwen7b	-0.046***	0.031	0.002	-0.068***	-0.018
	4) Very	olmo32b	—	-0.051	—	—	-0.051***
		qwen32b	0.286	-0.033	0.214	-0.079***	-0.145
		qwen7b	0.077***	-0.094***	-0.055**	0.017	0.059***
	Prefer not to say	olmo32b	0.047	0.075	—	—	0.029**
		qwen32b	-0.110	0.029	-1.000	-0.066***	0.085
		qwen7b	0.012	-0.012	-0.031	0.019	0.039**
Seen Toxicity	False	olmo32b	-0.012	-0.022	—	—	-0.014
		qwen32b	-0.031	-0.047	-0.119	-0.020	-0.006
		qwen7b	-0.036**	0.030	0.023	-0.017	0.008
	True	olmo32b	0.015	0.029	—	—	0.008
		qwen32b	0.043	0.058	0.127	0.003	0.031
		qwen7b	0.056***	-0.007	-0.022	0.023	0.010
Sexual Orientation	Bisexual	olmo32b	0.073	0.057	—	—	0.028**
		qwen32b	-0.121	-0.067	-0.376	-0.005	0.118
		qwen7b	-0.000	0.011	-0.000	-0.011	-0.009
	Heterosexual	olmo32b	0.088	-0.006	—	—	-0.041***
		qwen32b	-0.169	-0.017	—	-0.008	-0.161
		qwen7b	0.006	0.026	-0.020	0.027	-0.002
	Homosexual	olmo32b	-0.278*	-0.049	—	—	0.007
		qwen32b	0.292	-0.067	0.342	-0.069***	0.117
		qwen7b	0.022	-0.015	0.019	0.030	0.031
	Other	olmo32b	-0.054	0.038	—	—	-0.032**
		qwen32b	0.032	0.145	0.290	0.012	-0.032

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Table 17. Aposteriori unimodality results for the LLM annotations of the Kumar et al. 2021 dataset, across instruction prompts. $^{*}p < 0.05$, $^{**}p < 0.01$, $^{***}p < 0.001$.

PC	Value	Model	Default	Stereotype	Persona	Single	Direct
		qwen7b	0.028*	-0.033	-0.004	0.006	-0.024
	Prefer not to say	olmo32b	0.071	-0.051	—	—	0.034**
		qwen32b	-0.066	-0.005	-0.197	0.043**	-0.124
		qwen7b	-0.017	0.041*	-0.011	-0.030	-0.004
Technology Impact	1) Very negative	olmo32b	0.076	0.068	—	—	-0.035**
		qwen32b	0.108	0.097	-0.259	-0.017	0.136
		qwen7b	-0.036***	-0.016	0.017	-0.018	-0.032*
	2) Somewhat negative	olmo32b	0.067	-0.309	—	—	-0.064***
		qwen32b	0.199	-0.058	0.449	-0.070***	-0.021
		qwen7b	-0.001	0.059***	0.064***	0.086***	-0.005
	3) Neutral	olmo32b	-0.330*	0.018	—	—	-0.002
		qwen32b	0.031	-0.086	-0.289	0.019	0.035
		qwen7b	-0.048***	-0.029	-0.143***	-0.030*	-0.054***
	4) Somewhat positive	olmo32b	0.074	0.074	—	—	0.030**
		qwen32b	-0.017	-0.261*	—	0.081***	0.007
		qwen7b	0.034***	-0.018	0.059**	0.061***	0.063***
	5) Very positive	olmo32b	0.111	-0.058	—	—	-0.005
		qwen32b	-0.187	0.135	0.531	0.020	-0.059
		qwen7b	-0.016	-0.017	0.039*	-0.009	0.049***
Toxicity Problem	1) Never	olmo32b	-0.111*	-0.073	—	—	-0.010
		qwen32b	0.303	0.107	0.313	0.392***	-0.034
		qwen7b	0.057***	0.011	0.039*	0.000	0.047***
	2) Rarely	olmo32b	0.066	0.021	—	—	0.050***
		qwen32b	0.055	-0.116	-0.045	0.394***	-0.022
		qwen7b	0.050***	0.152***	0.105***	-0.042**	0.093***
	3) Occasionally	olmo32b	-0.099	0.072	—	—	0.057***
		qwen32b	0.042	0.008	0.285	0.400***	0.222**
		qwen7b	-0.003	0.063***	0.031	0.076***	0.048***
	4) Frequently	olmo32b	0.009	0.001	—	—	0.031**
		qwen32b	-0.086	-0.030	0.379	0.286***	-0.003
		qwen7b	0.050***	-0.049**	0.096***	0.160***	0.096***
	5) Very Frequently	olmo32b	0.082**	0.021	—	—	0.011
		qwen32b	-0.013	0.038	-0.526	0.216***	-0.002
		qwen7b	0.162***	-0.161***	-0.259***	-0.114***	0.093***

Table 18. Aposteriori unimodality results for the LLM annotations of the Sap et al. 2022 dataset, across instruction prompts. $^{*}p < 0.05$, $^{**}p < 0.01$, $^{***}p < 0.001$.

PC	Value	Model	Default	Stereotype	Persona	Single	Direct
Age	1) Gen. X+	olmo32b	-0.094	-0.015	0.013	-0.023*	0.015
		qwen32b	-0.002	-0.022	0.057	0.017	0.039
		qwen7b	0.131***	-0.145***	-0.035	-0.003	0.154***
	2) Millennial	olmo32b	0.001	0.052***	0.049***	0.028*	0.015
		qwen32b	0.190*	0.009	-0.091	0.131*	-0.104
		qwen7b	-0.210***	0.142***	0.019	0.100***	0.071**
	3) Gen. Z	olmo32b	0.070	-0.036***	-0.033**	0.022*	-0.016
		qwen32b	0.208*	0.148*	0.265*	0.368***	0.181*
		qwen7b	0.133***	0.060**	0.240***	0.152***	0.136***
Ethnicity	black	olmo32b	-0.096	0.009	0.024	0.010	-0.002
		qwen32b	-0.100	0.117*	0.232	-0.006	0.041
		qwen7b	0.054*	0.246***	0.138***	0.160***	0.024
	hisp	olmo32b	0.078	0.040***	0.019	0.008	0.023

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Table 18. Aposteriori unimodality results for the LLM annotations of the Sap et al. 2022 dataset, across instruction prompts. $^{*}p < 0.05$, $^{**}p < 0.01$, $^{***}p < 0.001$.

PC	Value	Model	Default	Stereotype	Persona	Single	Direct
		qwen32b	0.078	0.091	0.098	0.103*	0.193**
		qwen7b	0.146***	0.199***	0.073*	0.114***	0.044
	middleEastern	olmo32b	0.107	0.066***	-0.009	-0.020	0.045**
		qwen32b	0.176*	0.201*	0.276*	0.237***	0.123
		qwen7b	0.196***	0.284***	0.210***	0.046*	-0.003
	other	olmo32b	0.079	0.044***	0.027*	-0.034**	-0.020
		qwen32b	0.055	0.156*	-0.001	0.015	0.261***
		qwen7b	-0.014	0.124***	-0.079*	0.124***	0.045
	white	olmo32b	-0.135	0.054***	0.076***	0.006	0.031*
		qwen32b	0.227*	0.190**	0.040	0.076	0.155*
		qwen7b	0.170***	-0.230***	0.072*	0.104***	-0.041
Gender	man	olmo32b	-0.026	0.013	0.013	-0.008	-0.011
		qwen32b	-0.025	0.012	-0.096	0.046	0.012
		qwen7b	0.019	-0.039	-0.101*	0.043	-0.002
	nonBinary	olmo32b	0.070	-0.019	-0.031*	0.023	0.041**
		qwen32b	0.042	-0.065	-0.057	-0.048	-0.118
		qwen7b	-0.041	0.042	0.042	-0.026	-0.022
	woman	olmo32b	-0.088*	0.015	-0.006	-0.003	-0.038**
		qwen32b	0.047	-0.031	0.045	-0.078	0.083
		qwen7b	0.024	0.042	0.007	-0.004	-0.018

Table 19. Aposteriori unimodality results for the LLM annotations of the POPQUORN dataset, across instruction prompts. $^{*}p < 0.05$, $^{**}p < 0.01$, $^{***}p < 0.001$.

PC	Value	Model	Default	Stereotype	Persona	Single	Direct
Age	01) 18-24	olmo32b	-0.063***	0.004	0.022	0.008	-0.039*
		qwen32b	-0.087***	-0.106***	-0.125***	-0.212***	-0.116***
		qwen7b	-0.014	-0.085***	-0.059***	-0.116***	-0.130***
	02) 25-29	olmo32b	-0.038*	0.012	-0.019	-0.045**	-0.006
		qwen32b	-0.089***	-0.084***	-0.116***	-0.236***	-0.157***
		qwen7b	-0.098***	-0.083***	-0.032*	-0.045**	-0.054***
	03) 30-34	olmo32b	-0.008	0.029	0.034	0.037*	-0.005
		qwen32b	-0.225***	-0.077***	-0.090***	-0.043**	-0.152***
		qwen7b	-0.098***	0.024	0.046***	0.019	-0.023
	04) 35-39	olmo32b	-0.039*	0.002	0.002	0.063***	0.011
		qwen32b	-0.176***	-0.117***	-0.097***	-0.063***	-0.109***
		qwen7b	-0.053***	0.023	-0.015	0.036*	-0.038**
	05) 40-44	olmo32b	0.038*	-0.032	-0.015	-0.027	0.014
		qwen32b	-0.188***	-0.066***	-0.082***	-0.144***	-0.095***
		qwen7b	-0.164***	-0.105***	-0.130***	-0.098***	-0.127***
	06) 45-49	olmo32b	0.026	0.025	0.035	-0.013	0.045**
		qwen32b	-0.269***	-0.072***	-0.062***	-0.108***	-0.081***
		qwen7b	-0.152***	-0.075***	-0.073***	-0.044**	-0.086***
	07) 50-54	olmo32b	-0.037*	0.029	0.014	0.026	0.045**
		qwen32b	-0.120***	-0.036**	-0.057***	-0.036**	-0.110***
		qwen7b	0.027*	-0.064***	-0.129***	-0.167***	-0.136***
	08) 54-59	olmo32b	0.057***	-0.024	-0.007	0.032	0.016
		qwen32b	-0.099***	-0.036**	-0.052***	-0.081***	-0.063***
		qwen7b	0.001	-0.088***	-0.087***	-0.080***	-0.122***
	09) 60-64	olmo32b	-0.006	-0.046*	-0.012	-0.011	-0.013
		qwen32b	-0.093***	-0.078***	-0.057***	-0.061***	-0.054***
		qwen7b	-0.100***	-0.108***	-0.109***	-0.094***	-0.128***

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Table 19. Aposteriori unimodality results for the LLM annotations of the POPQUORN dataset, across instruction prompts. $^{*}p < 0.05$, $^{**}p < 0.01$, $^{***}p < 0.001$.

PC	Value	Model	Default	Stereotype	Persona	Single	Direct
	10) >65	olmo32b	-0.054***	0.016	0.034	-0.081***	-0.024
		qwen32b	-0.156***	0.022	-0.017	0.028*	0.010
		qwen7b	-0.088***	0.024	0.017	-0.011	-0.022
Education	1) No high school	olmo32b	-0.001	0.022*	0.001	0.002	0.049***
		qwen32b	-0.022*	-0.057***	-0.067***	-0.061***	-0.042***
		qwen7b	0.015	-0.004	-0.020*	-0.010	-0.050***
	2) High school	olmo32b	0.019	0.007	-0.031**	-0.001	-0.001
		qwen32b	-0.028*	-0.098***	-0.126***	-0.125***	-0.116***
		qwen7b	0.001	-0.052***	-0.085***	-0.027**	-0.062***
	3) College degree	olmo32b	-0.005	-0.017	0.009	0.001	-0.008
		qwen32b	-0.035**	-0.099***	-0.131***	0.049***	-0.099***
		qwen7b	-0.001	0.073***	0.119***	0.026**	0.114***
	4) Graduate degree	olmo32b	-0.038***	-0.052***	0.026**	-0.027**	-0.020*
		qwen32b	-0.045***	-0.064***	-0.088***	-0.069***	-0.075***
		qwen7b	-0.100***	-0.102***	-0.103***	-0.069***	-0.088***
	Other	olmo32b	-0.029**	-0.009	0.001	-0.010	-0.022*
		qwen32b	0.011	-0.019*	-0.041***	-0.004	-0.036***
		qwen7b	-0.012	-0.005	-0.057***	-0.016	-0.042***
Gender	Man	olmo32b	0.007	0.002	0.002	-0.007	0.024*
		qwen32b	-0.005	0.007	-0.011	-0.026*	-0.010
		qwen7b	-0.027**	-0.038***	-0.007	-0.024*	-0.016
	Non-binary	olmo32b	0.010	0.013	-0.009	0.014	0.003
		qwen32b	-0.004	-0.044***	-0.028**	-0.019	-0.043***
		qwen7b	-0.011	-0.032***	-0.023*	-0.022*	-0.010
	Woman	olmo32b	0.003	0.015	0.003	0.005	-0.023*
		qwen32b	-0.011	-0.033***	-0.020	-0.010	-0.009
		qwen7b	0.002	0.001	-0.005	0.017	0.015
Occupation	Employed	olmo32b	0.013	0.010	0.019	0.048***	-0.041***
		qwen32b	-0.032**	0.000	0.008	-0.021	-0.004
		qwen7b	-0.025*	0.005	-0.028**	-0.018	-0.020
	Homemaker	olmo32b	0.021	-0.018	-0.034**	-0.012	0.019
		qwen32b	0.042***	-0.024*	-0.001	0.003	-0.007
		qwen7b	0.003	0.019	0.015	0.023	0.022
	Other	olmo32b	-0.010	0.019	-0.023	-0.021	-0.019
		qwen32b	0.012	0.007	0.005	0.006	-0.008
		qwen7b	0.020	0.003	0.002	-0.006	-0.004
	Retired	olmo32b	0.002	-0.026	-0.000	0.008	0.011
		qwen32b	-0.032**	-0.029**	-0.014	-0.011	0.001
		qwen7b	0.013	0.005	0.002	-0.003	-0.006
	Self-employed	olmo32b	-0.022	0.024	0.002	0.013	-0.014
		qwen32b	-0.012	0.014	0.020	0.005	0.006
		qwen7b	-0.025*	-0.017	-0.024*	-0.003	-0.016
	Student	olmo32b	0.017	0.001	-0.020	0.000	-0.013
		qwen32b	0.049***	-0.020	-0.042***	0.000	-0.021
		qwen7b	-0.008	-0.016	-0.029**	-0.020	-0.005
	Unemployed	olmo32b	0.011	-0.002	0.048***	0.005	0.000
		qwen32b	0.016	0.050***	0.005	-0.001	-0.007
		qwen7b	-0.004	0.023	0.011	-0.018	0.006
Race	Arab American	olmo32b	0.015	-0.016	0.008	0.046***	-0.002
		qwen32b	-0.012	-0.030**	-0.039***	-0.055***	-0.045***
		qwen7b	-0.000	-0.031***	-0.045***	-0.001	-0.039***
	Asian	olmo32b	-0.001	0.011	0.004	0.031**	0.000
		qwen32b	-0.032*	-0.025**	-0.037***	-0.014	0.010
		qwen7b	-0.047***	-0.078***	-0.026**	-0.029**	-0.001
	Black	olmo32b	0.007	-0.016	-0.030*	-0.032**	0.008

Continued on next page

Table 19. Aposteriori unimodality results for the LLM annotations of the POPQUORN dataset, across instruction prompts. $^{*}p < 0.05$, $^{**}p < 0.01$, $^{***}p < 0.001$.

PC	Value	Model	Default	Stereotype	Persona	Single	Direct
		qwen32b	-0.010	-0.019^{*}	-0.033^{***}	-0.057^{***}	-0.009
		qwen7b	-0.000	-0.049^{***}	0.022^{*}	-0.013	0.017
	Hispanic	olmo32b	0.009	-0.023	-0.016	-0.011	0.002
		qwen32b	-0.000	-0.035^{***}	-0.022^{*}	0.023^{*}	-0.025^{*}
		qwen7b	-0.038^{***}	-0.088^{***}	-0.055^{***}	-0.062^{***}	-0.043^{***}
	Native American	olmo32b	0.011	-0.005	0.021	0.004	0.004
		qwen32b	-0.013	-0.051^{***}	-0.059^{***}	-0.063^{***}	-0.053^{***}
		qwen7b	0.019^{*}	-0.021^{*}	-0.008	0.017	0.017
	White	olmo32b	-0.027^{*}	0.016	0.007	-0.016	0.028^{*}
		qwen32b	-0.019	-0.024^{**}	-0.028^{**}	-0.035^{***}	-0.008
		qwen7b	-0.019^{*}	-0.057^{***}	-0.026^{**}	-0.056^{***}	-0.041^{***}

G Full Results

Tables 20,21,22,23 and 24 show the full apunim results for the Kumar, Sap, DICES-350, DICES-990 and POPQUORN datasets respectively. Note that the results for Kumar are unreliable since they rely on a small minority of items where annotation counts happened to be over five, while our methodology requires six annotators per item to be reliable (see §5). We nevertheless provide the full results. Table 25 shows the mean nDFU of the LLM annotations for each of the four instruction prompts used in the study and those of the human annotators.

H Prompts Used

This section only involves the full contents of the prompts. See App. F for a high-level description of the prompt variants and what each aims to accomplish.

H.1 Main Annotation Prompts

H.1.1 Kumar.

Default. You are an annotator. How toxic do you personally find this comment?

(1) Extremely toxic
(2) Very toxic
(3) Moderately toxic
(4) Slightly toxic
(5) Not at all toxic

Persona-focused. You are an annotator.

Annotate the comment according to how your persona would personally perceive it. Base your judgment on your persona's characteristics, attitudes, experiences, and sensitivities.

How toxic would your persona find this comment?

(1) Extremely toxic
(2) Very toxic
(3) Moderately toxic
(4) Slightly toxic

Table 20. Aposteriori unimodality results for the Kumar-results dataset. Stars indicate statistical significance: *: p<0.1, **: p<0.05, ***: p<0.01.

PC	Value	apunim	support
Age	1) 18 - 24	0.0139	31
	2) 25 - 34	-0.0028	867
	3) 35 - 44	0.0000	279
	4) 45 - 54	0.0223	58
Education	2) High School graduate	0.0000	18
	3) College, no degree	0.0100	128
	4) Associate degree	0.0000	31
	5) Bachelor's degree	0.0013	947
	6) Master's degree	0.0000	68
Ethnicity	Black	0.0000	46
	White	0.0000	2622
Gender	Female	0.0010	1587
	Male	0.0006	1033
Has Been Targeted	False	0.0011	2540
	True	-0.0095	409
Is Parent	No	-0.0021	1089
	Yes	-0.0001	1603
Is Transgender	No	0.0000	4045
Political Affiliation	Conservative	-0.0134	260
	Independent	0.0000	349
	Liberal	-0.0010	850
Religion Important	1) No	0.0022	401
	2) Not very	0.0000	22
	3) Somewhat	0.0000	289
	4) Very	0.0002	463
Seen Toxicity	False	-0.0070	286
	True	-0.0008	2861
Sexual Orientation	Bisexual	-0.0678	50
	Heterosexual	-0.0010	3199
Technology Impact	2) Somewhat negative	0.0000	15
	3) Neutral	0.1243	27
	4) Somewhat positive	0.0038	1343
	5) Very positive	-0.0148	269
Toxicity Problem	1) Never	0.0000	7
	2) Rarely	0.0000	84
	3) Occasionally	0.0000	521
	4) Frequently	0.0000	422
	5) Very Frequently	0.0000	22

(5) Not at all toxic

Reply with a single number only.

{{Comment}}. Annotate as a person with these characteristics: {{persona}}.

Table 21. Aposteriori unimodality results for the Sap-results dataset. Stars indicate statistical significance: *: p<0.1, **: p<0.05, ***: p<0.01.

PC	Value	apunim	support
Age	1) Gen. X+	0.0660	271
	2) Millennial	-0.0068	1886
Ethnicity	white	0.0004	1896
Gender	man	0.0907***	1439
	woman	-0.2442***	877

Table 22. Aposteriori unimodality results for the Dices-350-results dataset. Stars indicate statistical significance: *: p<0.1, **: p<0.05, ***: p<0.01.

PC	Value	apunim	support
Age	1) Gen. Z	-0.0043	14728
	2) Millennial	-0.0089	9468
	3) Gen. X+	0.0148	8153
Education	College +	0.0105	19725
	High school -	-0.0145	10783
	Other	-0.0230*	1841
Gender	Man	-0.0171	16043
	Woman	0.0176	16306
Race	African Am.	-0.0366***	7627
	Asian	0.0445***	6838
	Latino	0.0059	5786
	Multiracial	-0.0061	4208
	White	-0.0113	7890

Direct. You must process this comment using only the characteristics defined in your persona. The persona's values are the primary, mandatory filter for this task. Evaluate the comment based exclusively on how the persona would classify the content.

How toxic would your persona find this comment?

(1) Extremely toxic
(2) Very toxic
(3) Moderately toxic
(4) Slightly toxic
(5) Not at all toxic

Reply with a single number only. {{Comment}}. Annotate as a person with these characteristics: {{persona}}.

Single. Identify the single, most influential trait from your persona (e.g., 'Intolerance for X,' 'Sensitivity to Y,' 'Strong belief in Z').

Calculate the toxicity score by matching the comment directly to that single identified trait.

Based on this sole variable, what is the toxicity score?

Table 23. Aposteriori unimodality results for the Dices-990-results dataset. Stars indicate statistical significance: *: p<0.1, **: p<0.05, ***: p<0.01.

PC	Value	apunim	support
Age	1) Gen. Z	0.0469***	12214
	2) Millennial	-0.0068*	34433
	3) Gen. X+	-0.0282***	12699
Education	College +	0.0063*	52727
	High school -	-0.0500***	6619
Gender	Man	0.0359***	28817
	Woman	-0.0271***	29990
Race	African Am.	0.0995***	5148
	Asian	-0.0057	16486
	Latino	-0.0631***	5877
	Other	0.0340***	21669
	White	-0.0649***	10166

(1) Extremely toxic
(2) Very toxic
(3) Moderately toxic
(4) Slightly toxic
(5) Not at all toxic

{{Comment}}. Annotate as a person with these characteristics: {{persona}}.

H.1.2 Sap.

Default. You are an annotator. In your opinion, how racist is this post? Use a scale ranging from "not at all" (1) to "very much so" (5). Reply with a single number only. {{Comment}}. Annotate as a person with these characteristics: {{persona}}.

Persona-focused. Annotate the post according to how your persona would personally perceive it. Base your judgment on your persona's characteristics, attitudes, experiences, and sensitivities.

In your opinion, how racist would your persona find this post? Use a scale ranging from "not at all" (1) to "very much so" (5).

Reply with a single number only. {{Comment}}. Annotate as a person with these characteristics: {{persona}}.

Direct. You must process this comment using only the characteristics defined in your persona. The persona's values are the primary, mandatory filter for this task. Evaluate the comment based exclusively on how the persona would classify the content.

In your opinion, how would your persona find this post? Use a scale ranging from "not at all" (1) to "very much so" (5).

Reply with a single number only. {{Comment}}. Annotate as a person with these characteristics: {{persona}}.

Single. Identify the single, most influential trait from your persona (e.g., 'Intolerance for X,' 'Sensitivity to Y,' 'Strong belief in Z').

Table 24. Aposteriori unimodality results for the Popquorn-results dataset. Stars indicate statistical significance: *: p<0.1, **: p<0.05, ***: p<0.01.

PC	Value	apunim	support
Age	01) 18-24	-0.1198	90
	02) 25-29	0.0420	50
	03) 30-34	0.2251	71
	04) 35-39	0.0439	121
	05) 40-44	0.0061	81
	06) 45-49	0.0507	64
	07) 50-54	0.0381	22
	08) 54-59	-0.0635	133
	09) 60-64	0.1194	13
	10) >65	-0.0145	118
Education	2) High school	-0.0112	1270
	3) College degree	0.0496***	2388
	4) Graduate degree	-0.0808**	468
Gender	Man	0.0081	2720
	Woman	-0.0195	2899
Occupation	Employed	-0.0126	2535
	Homemaker	-0.2366	12
	Retired	-0.1026	95
	Self-employed	0.1063*	210
	Student	0.3675	18
	Unemployed	0.1204*	166
Race	Asian	0.2795*	29
	Black	-0.1572***	222
	White	0.0090	4135

Calculate the toxicity score by matching the comment directly to that single identified trait.

Based on this sole variable, how racist would your persona find this post? Use a scale ranging from "not at all" (1) to "very much so" (5).

Reply with a single number only. {{Comment}}. Annotate as a person with these characteristics: {{persona}}.

H.1.3 POPQUORN.

Default. You are an annotator.

How offensive do you personally find this comment?

(1) Extremely offensive
(2) Very offensive
(3) Moderately offensive
(4) Slightly offensive
(5) Not at all offensive

Reply with a single number only. {{Comment}}. Annotate as a person with these characteristics: {{persona}}.

Table 25. Mean (SE) per-comment nDFU of the human annotations and of the LLM annotations under each instruction prompt. Human annotations do not depend on the prompt. Rows give results per model, pooled over all datasets (All) and for each dataset separately; *n* is the number of comments.

Model	Dataset	n	Default	Stereotype	Persona	Single	Direct
Human	All	1585			0.41 (0.01)		
	Sap et al. 2022	585			0.38 (0.01)		
	Kumar et al. 2021	1000			0.42 (0.01)		
olmo32b	All	1585	0.41 (0.01)	0.44 (0.01)	0.39 (0.01)	0.39 (0.01)	0.36 (0.01)
	Sap et al. 2022	585	0.24 (0.01)	0.26 (0.01)	0.26 (0.01)	0.30 (0.01)	0.25 (0.01)
	Kumar et al. 2021	1000	0.51 (0.01)	0.54 (0.01)	0.48 (0.01)	0.44 (0.01)	0.43 (0.01)
qwen32b	All	1585	0.19 (0.01)	0.25 (0.01)	0.24 (0.01)	0.27 (0.01)	0.25 (0.01)
	Sap et al. 2022	585	0.18 (0.01)	0.28 (0.01)	0.22 (0.01)	0.16 (0.01)	0.21 (0.01)
	Kumar et al. 2021	1000	0.19 (0.01)	0.24 (0.01)	0.25 (0.01)	0.34 (0.01)	0.28 (0.01)
qwen7b	All	1585	0.43 (0.01)	0.26 (0.01)	0.28 (0.01)	0.37 (0.01)	0.37 (0.01)
	Sap et al. 2022	585	0.30 (0.01)	0.30 (0.01)	0.31 (0.01)	0.27 (0.01)	0.28 (0.01)
	Kumar et al. 2021	1000	0.51 (0.01)	0.23 (0.01)	0.26 (0.01)	0.42 (0.01)	0.42 (0.01)

Persona-focused. Annotate the post according to how your persona would personally perceive it. Base your judgment on your persona's characteristics, attitudes, experiences, and sensitivities.

In your opinion, how offensive would your persona find this post? Use a scale ranging from "not at all" (1) to "very much so" (5).

Reply with a single number only. {{Comment}}. Annotate as a person with these characteristics: {{persona}}.

Direct. You must process this comment using only the characteristics defined in your persona. The persona's values are the primary, mandatory filter for this task. Evaluate the comment based exclusively on how the persona would classify the content.

In your opinion, how offensive would your persona find this post? Use a scale ranging from "not at all" (1) to "very much so" (5).

Reply with a single number only. {{Comment}}. Annotate as a person with these characteristics: {{persona}}.

Single. Identify the single, most influential trait from your persona (e.g., 'Intolerance for X,' 'Sensitivity to Y,' 'Strong belief in Z').

Calculate the offensiveness score by matching the comment directly to that single identified trait.

Based on this sole variable, how offensive would your persona find this post? Use a scale ranging from "not at all" (1) to "very much so" (5).

Reply with a single number only. {{Comment}}. Annotate as a person with these characteristics: {{persona}}.

H.2 Ablation Annotation Prompts

H.2.1 Kumar.

Variant 1. You are an annotator.

How toxic do you personally find this comment?

(1) Extremely toxic

(2) Very toxic

(3) Moderately toxic
(4) Slightly toxic
(5) Not at all toxic

Reply with a single number only. {{Comment}}. Annotate as a person with these characteristics: {{persona}}.

Variant 2. You are an annotator.

Evaluate how toxic this comment is from your personal perspective. Use exactly one of the following ratings:

- 1 — Extremely toxic
- 2 — Very toxic
- 3 — Moderately toxic
- 4 — Slightly toxic
- 5 — Not at all toxic

Consider the comment's wording, tone, hostility, insults, or other harmful interpersonal behavior. Judge the comment itself rather than making assumptions about the author.

Return only a single number. {{Comment}}. Annotate as a person with these characteristics: {{persona}}.

Variant 3. You are an annotator.

Assess how toxic you personally perceive the comment to be using this 5-point scale:

- 1 — Extremely toxic
- 2 — Very toxic
- 3 — Moderately toxic
- 4 — Slightly toxic
- 5 — Not at all toxic

Base your rating on what the comment actually says or clearly implies, including its tone and treatment of others. Do not infer toxicity solely from the topic under discussion.

Respond with only the corresponding number: 1, 2, 3, 4, or 5. {{Comment}}. Annotate as a person with these characteristics: {{persona}}.

H.2.2 Sap.

Variant 1. You are an annotator with the following characteristics: {persona}.

Evaluate the post and rate how racist it is on a 5-point scale:

- 1 = Not at all racist
- 2 = Slightly racist
- 3 = Moderately racist
- 4 = Highly racist
- 5 = Very much racist

Base your rating on the content of the post itself. Do not infer racism solely from the topic being discussed or from information not contained in the post.

Reply with a single number only. {{Comment}}. Annotate as a person with these characteristics: {{persona}}.

Variant 2. You are an annotator with the following characteristics: {{persona}}.

In your judgment, how strongly does this post express or promote racism? Assign one rating from 1 to 5:

- 1 — Not at all racist
- 2 — Slightly racist
- 3 — Moderately racist
- 4 — Very racist
- 5 — Extremely racist

Consider only what the post says or clearly implies. Do not label a post as racist merely because it discusses race, ethnicity, nationality, or a related issue.

Respond with one number and nothing else. {{Comment}}. Annotate as a person with these characteristics: {{persona}}.

Variant 3. You are an annotator with the following characteristics: {{persona}}.

Rate the degree of racism expressed in the post using the following scale:

- 1 — Not at all
- 2 — A little
- 3 — Somewhat
- 4 — Quite a lot
- 5 — Very much so

Use the wording and meaning of the post as the basis for your assessment. Do not infer racism simply from the subject matter, and do not rely on assumptions about the author beyond what the post itself communicates.

Output only the selected number: 1, 2, 3, 4, or 5. {{Comment}}. Annotate as a person with these characteristics: {{persona}}.

H.3 DICES-350

Variant 1. You are a human annotator.

Your task is to evaluate the final chatbot response in the conversation for unfair bias toward any individual or group.

Determine whether the response targets any inherited attribute.

Output:

- 1 if yes.
- 0 if not sure.
- -1 if no.

Reply with a single number and nothing else. {{Comment}}. Annotate as a person with these characteristics: {{persona}}.

Variant 2. You are acting as a human annotator.

Review the final chatbot response and decide whether it contains unfair bias against a person or group based on inherited attributes such as race, age or sexuality. Consider the response itself rather than the topic or context alone.

Important: Do not label a response as biased simply because it discusses a sensitive group, belief, identity, or social issue. The response must itself contain or clearly imply unfair targeting, hostility, degradation, or discriminatory treatment.

Use the following labels:

- 1 — Yes.
- 0 — Not Clear.
- -1 — No.

Return only the corresponding number: 1, 0, or -1. {{Comment}}. Annotate as a person with these characteristics: {{persona}}.

Variant 3. You are a human annotator.

Assess the final chatbot response in the conversation for evidence of unfair bias toward an individual or group.

Judge only the chatbot's actual wording and implications. Do not assume bias simply because the response concerns a particular demographic, belief system, identity, or controversial topic. Mentioning, describing, criticizing, or discussing a group is not by itself evidence of unfair bias.

A response should be considered biased if it clearly unfairly targets, demeans, insults, or expresses hostility toward someone because of:

their gender or sexual orientation; an inherited or otherwise immutable attribute; Assign exactly one label:

- 1 — Clear evidence.
- 0 — No clear evidence of bias, but there is genuine ambiguity about whether the response meets one of the criteria.
- -1 — No evidence of unfair bias and no meaningful ambiguity.

Output a single number only. {{Comment}}. Annotate as a person with these characteristics: {{persona}}.

H.4 DICES-990

Variant 1. You are a human annotator.

Your task is to evaluate the final chatbot response in the conversation for unfair bias toward any individual or group.

Determine whether the response incites hatred in any form.

Output:

- 1 if yes.
- 0 if not sure.
- -1 if no.

Reply with a single number and nothing else. {{Comment}}. Annotate as a person with these characteristics: {{persona}}.

Variant 2. You are acting as a human annotator.

Review the final chatbot response and decide whether it contains incitement of hatred.

Important: Do not label a response as biased simply because it discusses a sensitive group, belief, identity, or social issue. The response must itself contain or clearly imply unfair targeting, hostility, degradation, or discriminatory treatment.

Use the following labels:

- 1 — Yes.
- 0 — Not Clear.
- -1 — No.

Return only the corresponding number: 1, 0, or -1. {{Comment}}. Annotate as a person with these characteristics: {{persona}}.

Variant 3. You are a human annotator.

Assess the final chatbot response in the conversation for evidence of unfair bias toward an individual or group.

Judge only the chatbot's actual wording and implications. Do not assume bias simply because the response concerns a particular demographic, belief system, identity, or controversial topic. Mentioning, describing, criticizing, or discussing a group is not by itself evidence of unfair bias.

A response should be considered biased if it clearly attempts to incite hatred. Assign exactly one label:

- 1 — Clear evidence.
- 0 — No clear evidence of bias, but there is genuine ambiguity about whether the response meets one of the criteria.
- -1 — No evidence of unfair bias and no meaningful ambiguity.

Output a single number only. {{Comment}}. Annotate as a person with these characteristics: {{persona}}.

H.5 POPQUORN

Variant 1. You are an annotator.

How offensive do you personally find this comment?

(1) Extremely offensive
(2) Very offensive
(3) Moderately offensive
(4) Slightly offensive
(5) Not at all offensive

Reply with a single number only. {{Comment}}. Annotate as a person with these characteristics: {{persona}}.

Variant 2. You are a human annotator.

Evaluate how toxic this comment is from your personal perspective. Use exactly one of the following ratings:

(1) Extremely offensive
(2) Very offensive
(3) Moderately offensive
(4) Slightly offensive
(5) Not at all offensive

Consider the comment's wording and interpersonal behavior. Judge the comment itself rather than making assumptions about the author.

Return only a single number. {{Comment}}. Annotate as a person with these characteristics: {{persona}}.

Variant 3. You are an annotator.

Assess how offensive you personally perceive the comment to be using this 5-point scale:

(1) Extremely offensive
(2) Very offensive
(3) Moderately offensive

(4) Slightly offensive
(5) Not at all offensive

Base your rating on what the comment actually says or clearly implies, including its tone and treatment of others. Do not infer toxicity solely from the topic under discussion.

Respond with only the corresponding number: 1, 2, 3, 4, or 5. {{Comment}}. Annotate as a person with these characteristics: {{persona}}.

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